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Frequently Asked Questions

Motor Insurance | Health Insurance | Claims | Renewals | Add-ons | Premiums

70+ Questions Answered in Detail — Complete Customer Reference Guide

Motor | Health | Claims | NCB | Add-ons | Renewals

Document Type	Frequently Asked Questions — Customer Reference Guide
Topics Covered	Car Insurance, Bike/EV Insurance, Health Insurance, Claims, NCB, Add-ons, Renewals, Digital Services, Premiums, Portability
Total Questions	70+ FAQs across 10 sections
Content Status	AI-Generated | Educational & RAG Project Use Only
Purpose	RAG Model Knowledge Base | Student Reference | Educational Training
Language	English | Jurisdiction: Republic of India

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SECTION A — CAR INSURANCE

Q A1. What types of car insurance does Acko offer and which is best for me?

A Acko offers three main types: (1) **Third Party Only (TP):** Mandatory by law under Section 146 of the Motor Vehicles Act, 1988. Covers damage or injury you cause to other people, vehicles, or property. Does NOT cover any damage to your own car. Cheapest option. (2) **Stand-Alone Own Damage (SAOD):** Covers ONLY your own car's damage — from accidents, fire, flood, theft, and natural calamities. Requires you to already have a valid TP policy from Acko or any other insurer. (3) **Comprehensive:** Combines both OD and TP into one policy. Best protection. Recommended for: all cars under 8 years old; cars worth above INR 4 lakhs; financed vehicles; cars in metro cities. **Our recommendation:** Comprehensive with Zero Depreciation add-on for new vehicles.

Q A2. Is car insurance mandatory in India? What are the penalties for driving without insurance?

A Yes — mandatory under the Motor Vehicles Act, 1988 (Section 146). At minimum, every vehicle on public roads must have a valid Third Party insurance policy. Penalties (Motor Vehicles Amendment Act, 2019): First offence — fine of INR 2,000 and/or imprisonment up to 3 months. Second offence — fine of INR 4,000 and/or imprisonment up to 3 months. Additionally, your vehicle can be impounded until valid insurance is produced. If you cause an accident without insurance, you bear the full liability — Third Party claims can run into crores for death or serious injury cases adjudicated by MACT tribunals.

Q A3. What exactly does Acko Comprehensive Car Insurance cover?

A Acko Comprehensive covers two broad categories: **Own Damage (OD):** Your car's physical damage from — road accidents and collisions; fire, explosion, self-ignition; natural calamities (flood, earthquake, cyclone, hailstorm, landslide); theft and burglary; riots, vandalism, civil commotion; damage while in transit; terrorist acts (IRDAI Terrorism Pool). **Third Party (TP) Liability:** Death or bodily injury to any third party — unlimited liability covered; third party property damage — up to INR 7.5 lakhs; compulsory personal accident cover for owner-driver — up to INR 15 lakhs. **Not covered:** Wear and tear; mechanical breakdown; driving drunk or without licence; overloading; outside India; depreciation on replaced parts (unless Zero Dep add-on is active).

Q A4. What is IDV and how does it affect my car insurance?

A IDV (Insured Declared Value) is the current market value of your car — calculated as: **IDV = Ex-showroom price × (1 – depreciation rate)**. Depreciation by age: new (0–6 months) = 5%; 6 months–1 year = 15%; 1–2 years = 20%; 2–3 years = 30%; 3–4 years = 40%; 4–5 years = 50%; above 5 years = mutual agreement. IDV matters because: it is the maximum Acko pays if your car is stolen or totalled; higher IDV = higher premium but better protection; lower IDV = lower premium but lower payout on total loss. Acko allows you to set IDV within ±15% of the calculated figure. For a car you plan to keep, always choose IDV closest to actual market resale value.

Q A5. What is NOT covered under car insurance? (Key Exclusions)

A Key exclusions from Acko car insurance: (1) **Wear and tear:** Normal mechanical or electrical breakdown not caused by an accident — engine seizure from oil neglect, clutch wear, rust and corrosion. (2) **DUI:** Driving while blood alcohol above 0.03% or under drug influence. (3) **Invalid licence:** Driver without valid licence for the vehicle class. (4) **Depreciation on parts:** 50% on plastic/rubber/tyre; 30% on fibre; removed by Zero Dep add-on. (5) **Consequential loss:** Loss of income while car is off-road, taxi bills during repair, hotel stays. (6) **Personal items stolen:** Phone, laptop, cash, jewellery from inside the car. (7) **Outside India:** No cover without prior Acko written approval. (8) **Racing/speed testing.** (9) **War and nuclear risks.** (10) **Overloading.**

Q A6. How do I buy Acko car insurance online? Step-by-step guide.

A Buying Acko car insurance takes under 5 minutes — entirely online: **Step 1:** Visit acko.com or open Acko app. **Step 2:** Click 'Car Insurance' → enter car registration number. **Step 3:** Acko auto-fills your car details (make, model, variant, year, fuel type). Verify and confirm. **Step 4:** Select coverage type: Comprehensive, SAOD, or TP Only. **Step 5:** Choose add-ons (Zero Dep, Engine Protection, RSA, NCB Protection, etc.). **Step 6:** Review IDV — adjust if needed within the ±15% band. **Step 7:** Enter personal details (name, DOB, address, previous insurer, NCB details). **Step 8:** Pay premium via UPI, net banking, debit/credit card. **Step 9:** Receive digital policy certificate instantly. No agent, no paperwork, no waiting.

Q A7. How is my car insurance premium calculated?

A Your premium has two parts — Own Damage (OD) and Third Party (TP): **OD Premium:** Calculated as IDV × applicable rate (typically 2.5%–4% for private cars, varies by vehicle segment and city zone). This base is then reduced by NCB discount (0–50%) and adjusted for: voluntary deductible chosen (reduces premium); add-ons selected (each increases premium); anti-theft device discount (2.5%); zone (Zone A metros = higher than Zone B). **TP Premium:** Fixed by IRDAI — INR 2,094 (up to 1,000 cc), INR 3,416 (1,000–1,500 cc), INR 7,897 (above 1,500 cc). Add OD + TP + Add-ons + 18% GST = your total premium. Example: 3-year-old City with 35% NCB and Zero Dep add-on: OD ≈ INR 15,000; TP = INR 3,416; Zero Dep ≈ INR 2,000; GST = INR 3,674; Total ≈ INR 24,090.

Q A8. What happens when my car is declared a Total Loss?

A Total Loss is declared when the estimated repair cost exceeds 75% of the IDV. Example: Car IDV = INR 8 lakhs. Repair estimate = INR 6.5 lakhs (81% of IDV) → Total Loss. Settlement process: (1) Acko's licensed surveyor inspects the vehicle and confirms Total Loss. (2) Acko pays the IDV minus compulsory deductible (INR 1,000–2,000) and any prior claim adjustments. (3) Vehicle title (RC) and salvage pass to Acko. You sign Form 28, 29, 30 for transfer. (4) If RTI Add-on is active: Acko pays original on-road invoice value instead of IDV. (5) Settlement typically takes 15–30 working days. **Tip:** If you have a loan on the car, Acko pays the bank (financier) first; any balance goes to you.

Q A9. My car was stolen. What are all the steps I need to follow?

A **Step 1 (Immediate):** File an FIR at the nearest police station. Get a copy. **Step 2 (Within 24 hours):** Inform Acko via the app — register a theft claim, upload FIR copy, enter incident details. **Step 3 (Within a week):** Submit all documentation to Acko: FIR copy; RC copy; all sets of vehicle keys (mandatory — surrender originals); driving licence copy; loan NOC from bank (if vehicle is financed); Form 26 (sale/transfer intimation to RTO). **Step 4 (After 90 days):** If vehicle not recovered, visit police station and request Non-Traceable Certificate (NTC). **Step 5:** Submit NTC to Acko. Also submit Form 28, 29, 30 (vehicle transfer forms for salvage). **Step 6:** Acko verifies all documents and settles the claim at IDV minus deductibles within 30–45 working days of NTC receipt.

Q A10. Does my car insurance cover flood damage? What about engine damage from flooding?

A **Standard Comprehensive cover:** YES — covers flood and inundation damage to the vehicle body, cabin, and electrical systems. This applies when flood water damages the exterior, seeps into the cabin and ruins upholstery, or damages electronics. **Engine damage from water ingression:** Under the standard OD policy, attempting to drive through a flooded road and causing hydrostatic lock of the engine is treated as consequential damage and EXCLUDED. This can cost INR 1–5 lakhs to fix. **Engine and Gearbox Protection Add-on:** Specifically covers hydrostatic lock, water ingression into the engine, and internal engine damage from flooding. STRONGLY recommended for Mumbai, Chennai, Bengaluru, Hyderabad, Kolkata — cities prone to urban flooding during monsoon. Without this add-on, driving through a waterlogged underpass could leave you with a destroyed engine and no claim.

Q A11. Can I transfer my car insurance to a new owner when selling the car?

A Yes and no — there are two parts: **Third Party section:** Transfers automatically to the new owner upon sale of the vehicle. The new owner is protected by TP from Day 1 of ownership. **Own Damage section:** Does NOT transfer automatically. OD belongs to you (the seller). When you sell the car: cancel the OD section with Acko and get a pro-rata premium refund for the remaining period; request an NCB certificate to take your accumulated NCB to your next vehicle. **New owner's responsibility:** The buyer must purchase fresh OD insurance from Acko (or any insurer) for their new car. They will start with 0% NCB unless they have their own prior NCB certificate. **RTO formality:** File Form 29 and 30 at the RTO within 14 days of sale to transfer registration.

Q A12. What is the benefit of the new 3-year long-term car insurance for new cars?

A Since September 2018 (Supreme Court order), all new private cars must have a 3-year Third Party insurance at purchase. Key aspects: **Premium certainty:** You pay the 3-year TP premium upfront. If IRDAI revises TP rates upward in years 2 or 3, you are protected — your premium doesn't change. **No annual TP renewal hassle:** One payment, 3 years of TP coverage without renewal reminders. **OD flexibility:** You can buy OD insurance from any insurer for 1 year at a time — this means you can switch OD insurers every year for a better deal. **NCB still applicable:** NCB is earned and lost based on OD claims only — the 3-year TP doesn't affect NCB calculation. **If you sell within 3 years:** The TP transfers to the new owner. You are entitled to a refund of unused TP premium from Acko.

SECTION B — TWO-WHEELER AND ELECTRIC VEHICLE INSURANCE

Q B1. Do I need insurance for my bike or scooter?

A Yes — motorcycle and scooter insurance is equally mandatory under Section 146 of the Motor Vehicles Act, 1988. Every two-wheeler plying on Indian public roads must have at least a valid Third Party insurance. All new two-wheelers sold since September 1, 2018 must carry a 5-year Third Party policy at the time of purchase. Penalty for riding without insurance: fine of INR 2,000 (first offence) and INR 4,000 (repeat). Your bike can also be seized until valid insurance is produced. Comprehensive bike insurance additionally covers your own bike from accidents, theft, and natural calamities — strongly recommended.

Q B2. How much does bike insurance cost? Can you give examples?

A Bike insurance premium = OD Premium + TP Premium + Add-ons + 18% GST. **TP Premium rates (IRDAI 2024-25):** Up to 75 cc: INR 538/year; 75–150 cc: INR 714/year; 150–350 cc: INR 1,366/year; above 350 cc: INR 2,804/year; electric two-wheelers (all): INR 687/year. **OD Premium:** Approximately 2.5%–4.5% of IDV. **Examples:** Honda Activa 6G (new, INR 82,000 IDV, 0% NCB): OD ≈ INR 2,300 + TP INR 714 + GST = Total ≈ INR 3,600/year. Royal Enfield Meteor 350 (2 years old, IDV INR 1.5 lakhs, 25% NCB): OD ≈ INR 3,375 + TP INR 1,366 + GST = Total ≈ INR 5,600/year. Ola S1 Pro EV (new): OD ≈ INR 3,800 + TP INR 687 + GST = Total ≈ INR 5,300/year.

Q B3. What does Acko bike insurance cover and not cover?

A **COVERED:** Accidental damage to your bike; fire and explosion; natural calamities (flood, storm, earthquake); theft; riots and vandalism; damage in transit; personal accident cover for owner-rider (INR 15 lakh). **NOT COVERED (Standard OD):** Mechanical breakdown not caused by accident; wear and tear; driving without valid licence; driving drunk; overloading beyond seating capacity (pillion = 1 person on standard 2-wheelers); consequential engine damage from water ingression (Engine Protection add-on needed); personal items stolen from bike; outside India. **SPECIFIC TO BIKES:** Helmet use is not mandatory for the claim to be paid, but non-helmet use may be noted in accident reports and affect Third Party liability determinations.

Q B4. What is Pillion Rider PA cover and should I buy it?

A The Compulsory PA cover (INR 15 lakh) under standard bike insurance protects ONLY the registered owner-rider. If your pillion passenger is seriously injured or killed in an accident, they are not covered under the standard policy. **Pillion Rider PA Add-on:** Covers your pillion passenger for: accidental death — INR 1,00,000 lump sum; permanent total disability — INR 1,00,000; permanent partial disability — proportionate per medical disability scale. Cost: typically INR 200–500 per year. **Should you buy it?** Yes, if you regularly ride with a pillion — especially spouse, children, or parents. The premium is negligible compared to the financial protection it provides. Note: covers one pillion at a time (not multiple passengers — bikes have seating for 2 including rider).

Q B5. Does Acko insure electric bikes like Ola S1, Ather 450X, TVS iQube?

A Yes — Acko fully insures all major electric two-wheelers. Supported models include: Ola Electric S1, S1 Pro, S1 Air; Ather 450X, 450S, 450 Gen 3; TVS iQube S, ST; Bajaj Chetak (electric); Hero Vida V1, V1 Pro; Ampere Magnus Pro, Zeal; Revolt RV400, RV300; Okinawa Praise Pro; Bounce Infinity E1; and all other IRDAI-registered EV models. **EV-specific features:** IDV includes the battery pack value; TP premium is a flat INR 687/year regardless of motor power (IRDAI EV incentive); standard OD does NOT cover battery damage from overcharging, deep discharge, or manufacturing defect — the EV add-on is needed; long-term 5-year TP is mandatory for new EVs too.

Q B6. My bike was stolen — what FIR details and documents do I need?

A **FIR requirements:** File FIR at the police station with jurisdiction over the area where the bike was stolen. FIR should contain: date, time, and location of theft; vehicle registration number; make, model, and colour; chassis number and engine number (from RC); description of circumstances. **Documents to submit to Acko:** Original FIR copy (police-stamped); original RC book; all sets of keys (mandatory — even the spare); driving licence copy; loan NOC letter from bank (if bike is financed); passport-size photographs. **After 90 days:** If bike not recovered, visit police station for Non-Traceable Certificate (NTC). Submit NTC + Forms 28, 29, 30 to Acko. **Settlement:** Acko pays IDV minus INR 100 (compulsory deductible for two-wheelers) within 30–45 working days of NTC receipt.

Q B7. Can I get a discount on bike insurance for installing anti-theft devices?

A Yes — IRDAI allows a 2.5% discount on the Own Damage premium for ARAI-approved anti-theft devices installed on two-wheelers. **How to avail the discount:** Purchase and install an ARAI-approved anti-theft system (immobiliser, GPS tracker with immobiliser, etc.). Get the device installed at an authorised fitment centre — they will issue a certificate. Submit the installation certificate (with ARAI approval number) to Acko at the time of policy purchase or renewal. Acko applies the 2.5% OD discount. **Important:** The discount applies only during years when the device is certified as installed. You may be asked to confirm its presence at renewal. ARAI-approved device list: www.araiindia.com.

Q B8. Is long-term bike insurance better than annual renewal?

A New two-wheelers must have a 5-year TP policy at purchase (mandatory since September 2018). The OD part can be annual or 5-year. **Advantages of 5-year OD bundled with TP:** No annual renewal hassle — 5 years, one payment; premium locked in — no exposure to future rate increases; zero risk of coverage gap from missed renewal; NCB is earned annually within the 5-year OD term. **Disadvantages:** Large upfront cost; if you sell the bike, cancellation and refund calculation is complex; you cannot easily switch OD insurer mid-term. **Acko's recommendation:** Buy 5-year bundled TP (mandatory) + 1-year OD each year. Renew OD annually with flexibility to switch or adjust coverage. This gives you the best of both worlds.

SECTION C — HEALTH INSURANCE

Q C1. Why do I need health insurance if my employer already covers me?

A Employer-provided group health insurance typically offers: INR 2–5 lakh sum insured; coverage only during employment (lapses if you change jobs or are laid off); no coverage for pre-existing diseases in many cases; no coverage for parents; no coverage outside India. **Gaps a personal policy fills:** Higher sum insured (INR 10–50 lakhs for serious illnesses like cancer or cardiac surgery); coverage during job changes, between jobs, freelancing; coverage for parents and in-laws; continuity of coverage regardless of employer; portability of waiting period credits; personal NCB/cumulative bonus. **Our recommendation:** Always have a personal health policy IN ADDITION to employer cover — use employer cover for smaller claims, personal for large ones. A INR 20 lakh Super Top-Up plan over a INR 5 lakh employer cover is a cost-effective combination.

Q C2. I have diabetes / hypertension. Can I get health insurance? Will it be covered?

A Yes — you can absolutely get health insurance even with pre-existing conditions like diabetes and hypertension. **What happens:** You declare these conditions honestly in the proposal form. Acko accepts the proposal (with rare exceptions for very severe conditions). A waiting period of 36 months (standard plans) or 12 months (Acko Platinum) applies to claims related to these pre-existing conditions. After the waiting period, all diabetes-related and hypertension-related hospitalisation is covered in full up to the Sum Insured. **Critical point:** Never hide a pre-existing condition. If undisclosed, Acko can reject any related claim even after years of premium payment. Disclosure protects you — the condition is covered after the waiting period regardless of cost.

Q C3. What is the difference between Individual and Family Floater health plans?

A **Individual Policy:** Each person has their own separate Sum Insured. Family of 4 with INR 5 lakh individual policies = INR 20 lakhs total coverage. Each member independently claims against their own INR 5 lakh. Best for families where multiple members are likely to have significant medical needs simultaneously. **Family Floater:** Shared pool for all members. INR 10 lakh floater = INR 10 lakhs available to the entire family collectively. If one member uses INR 10 lakhs (cardiac surgery), nothing remains for others that year. Restoration benefit partially mitigates this. Typically 30–40% cheaper than equivalent individual policies for the family. **Best for floater:** Young, healthy families with low expected claim frequency; families where one major illness per year is more likely than simultaneous illnesses across members.

Q C4. What are all the waiting periods I should know about before buying Acko health insurance?

A There are five key waiting periods: (1) **Initial / Cooling-off — 30 days:** No illness claims in first 30 days. Accidental injuries covered from Day 1. (2) **Pre-Existing Disease (PED) — 36 months** (standard) or 12 months (Platinum): Any condition you had in the 48 months before first policy date. (3) **Specific Disease — 24 months:** Cataract, hernia, joint replacement, piles, sinusitis, tonsillitis, BPH, spinal disc problems, gallstones. Even if newly diagnosed, these wait 24 months. (4) **Maternity — 24 months from add-on inclusion:** Normal delivery, C-section, complications. (5) **Bariatric Surgery — 36 months:** Even with the add-on. **Key tip:** Start your health insurance early in life when you are healthy — by the time you need it, all waiting periods will have been served. Waiting periods do not restart at renewal.

Q C5. How does the Restoration Benefit work in practice?

A Example: You have Acko Health Plus with INR 10 lakh Sum Insured. In January: your father (on the policy) undergoes cardiac bypass — total claim INR 8.5 lakhs. Remaining Sum Insured: INR 1.5 lakhs. In March: your mother (on the floater policy) is hospitalised for a kidney infection — estimated bill INR 2.5 lakhs. **Without Restoration:** Only INR 1.5 lakhs remaining — you pay INR 1 lakh out of pocket. **With Restoration:** Restoration kicks in after father's claim — Sum Insured is restored to INR 10 lakhs for a DIFFERENT illness. Mother's kidney infection (different illness) is covered from the restored pool: full INR 2.5 lakhs paid. **Critical rule:** Restored amount cannot be used for the same illness that triggered the restoration. If father needs a second cardiac procedure, the restored pool doesn't apply for that. New claim for a different illness — yes.

Q C6. What is Room Rent Limit and how does it impact my claim?

A Room Rent Limit is the cap on daily hospital room accommodation costs Acko will cover. But it has a cascading effect that surprises many claimants. **Example:** Your policy Room Rent Limit = INR 3,000/day. You choose a room at INR 6,000/day. Ratio: INR 3,000/INR 6,000 = 50%. Acko pays 50% of NOT just room charges, but also: surgeon's fees (50%); anaesthetist's fees (50%); operation theatre charges (50%); ICU charges (50%); nursing charges (50%). On a INR 5 lakh surgery, this can mean Acko pays only INR 2.5 lakhs instead of INR 5 lakhs. **Best practice:** ALWAYS choose a hospital room within your policy's Room Rent Limit. On Acko Platinum, there is NO Room Rent Limit — any room category is covered.

Q C7. Does health insurance cover mental health treatment?

A Yes — following the Mental Healthcare Act 2017 and IRDAI's 2023 circular, Acko covers in-patient treatment for diagnosed mental health conditions including: clinical depression (major depressive disorder); anxiety disorders (GAD, panic disorder, OCD, PTSD); bipolar disorder (Type I and II); schizophrenia and psychotic disorders; eating disorders (anorexia, bulimia — when requiring hospitalisation); medically supervised psychiatric detoxification. **Requirements:** Treatment at a licensed psychiatric facility (minimum 10 psychiatric beds); diagnosis by a registered psychiatrist; in-patient admission of 24+ hours (or daycare for specific procedures). **Not covered:** Outpatient OPD psychiatric consultations; psychotherapy sessions without hospitalisation; counselling; online mental health apps. Coverage is available on Health Plus and Platinum plans.

Q C8. Is AYUSH treatment (Ayurveda, Homeopathy) covered?

A Yes — Acko covers in-patient AYUSH treatment at government-recognised AYUSH hospitals, available on Health Plus and Platinum plans. **What is covered:** In-patient Panchakarma treatment at NABH-accredited Ayurvedic hospitals; in-patient Siddha treatment (especially relevant in Tamil Nadu); in-patient Unani treatment; Homeopathy in-patient treatment at registered facilities; Naturopathy in-patient treatment at approved naturopathy hospitals. **Coverage limit:** Up to 25% of Sum Insured per year. **What is NOT covered:** AYUSH treatment at home; outpatient AYUSH consultations; treatment at unregistered practitioners; general wellness packages; non-hospitalised Panchakarma. **Best practice:** Check the specific hospital's NABH or government recognition status before admission.

Q C9. What is the Super Top-Up plan and who should buy it?

A The Super Top-Up is a deductible-based additional health coverage layer. It activates only when your total medical expenses in a policy year exceed your chosen deductible threshold. **How it works:** Buy Super Top-Up with INR 20 lakh coverage and INR 5 lakh deductible. In a year: all expenses up to INR 5 lakhs paid from your base policy (or employer cover or out-of-pocket). If expenses go beyond INR 5 lakhs, Acko's Super Top-Up pays the excess — up to INR 20 lakhs. **Cost advantage:** A INR 20 lakh Super Top-Up with INR 5 lakh deductible costs approximately 60–70% less in premium than a INR 20 lakh base policy. **Ideal for:** Those with employer cover (INR 3–5 lakh) who want higher protection for major illnesses; senior citizens who already have a base policy; individuals wanting to supplement their existing coverage cost-effectively.

Q C10. Can I port my existing health policy from another insurance company to Acko?

A Yes — IRDAI guarantees this right. Key benefits of porting to Acko: All waiting period credits accumulated with your previous insurer transfer to Acko. Example: 2 years served with previous insurer's 36-month PED waiting period = only 14 more months needed with Acko. **How to port:** Submit portability application to Acko minimum 45 days before your current policy expires. Acko reviews and has 15 days to respond. Provide: last 3 years' policy schedules from previous insurer; complete claim history; fresh Acko proposal form; any recent medical reports requested by Acko. **Acko cannot refuse** portability except on genuine underwriting grounds (not arbitrary refusal). **You can also increase Sum Insured** when porting — the incremental amount is subject to fresh waiting periods.

SECTION D — CLAIMS PROCESS — MOTOR AND HEALTH

Q D1. How do I register a claim with Acko? All methods explained.

A Acko offers multiple digital channels for claim registration — all available 24x7: **(1) Acko App (Recommended):** Open app → My Policies → Select policy → File a Claim → Follow guided steps. For motor: photo upload guide included. For health: pre-auth or reimbursement option. **(2) Acko Website:** acko.com → My Account → Claims → File New Claim. **(3) WhatsApp:** Send your policy number and brief description to Acko's WhatsApp business number (check acko.com for current number). **(4) Email:** claims@acko.com (motor) or healthclaims@acko.com (health) — longer response time than app. After registration: you receive a Claim Reference Number (CRN) — use this for all future communication and tracking.

Q D2. What should I do IMMEDIATELY after a car accident? Step-by-step.

A **At the scene:** (1) Switch on hazard lights; move to safe position if possible. (2) Check for injuries — call 108 for ambulance if anyone is hurt. (3) Do NOT admit liability verbally or sign anything at the scene. (4) Take photos immediately — damage to your car (6 photos minimum), damage to third-party vehicle, accident scene, number plates. (5) Note down: third-party vehicle registration number, driver name, contact number. (6) Call police for FIR if: anyone is injured; significant third-party property damage; hit and run. **Within 24 hours:** (7) Register claim on Acko app. (8) File FIR if applicable. (9) Do NOT repair the vehicle before Acko's surveyor inspects (for major damage). **Within 48 hours:** (10) Take vehicle to Acko network garage for cashless or inform Acko about your preferred reimbursement garage.

Q D3. How long does Acko take to settle claims? What are the SLAs?

A Acko's target claim settlement timelines: **Motor Insurance:** Minor AI-assessed cashless: 60 minutes–3 hours; Minor standard cashless: 1–3 working days; Major cashless: 3–7 working days; Reimbursement (complete docs): 7–14 working days; Total loss: 15–30 working days; Theft claim: 30–45 working days after NTC. **Health Insurance:** Cashless pre-authorisation: 2–6 hours (planned); 2 hours (emergency); Final bill settlement (cashless): within 7 working days of discharge; Reimbursement claim (complete documents): 15 working days; Pre/post-hospitalisation reimbursement: 7–10 working days. **Note:** IRDAI mandates that undisputed claims must be settled within 30 days of receiving all required documents. Acko aims to beat this by a significant margin.

Q D4. My claim was rejected. What can I do?

A A claim rejection is not necessarily final. Follow this escalation path: **Step 1 — Review rejection letter:** Acko must give written reasons citing the specific policy clause or exclusion. Read it carefully. **Step 2 — Gather evidence:** If you believe the rejection is incorrect, collect supporting documents: additional medical reports, police records, garage certificates, weather data (for natural calamity claims). **Step 3 — Submit representation:** Write to Acko's claims department (claims@acko.com) within 30 days of rejection with all supporting evidence. Acko's senior team reviews within 15 working days. **Step 4 — Formal grievance:** Email grievance@acko.com — Acko must respond within 15 working days. **Step 5 — IRDAI IGMS:** File at igms.irda.gov.in if Acko doesn't resolve in 15 days. **Step 6 — Insurance Ombudsman:** Free, independent resolution for claims up to INR 30 lakhs. Contact details at cioins.co.in. Ombudsman decisions are binding on insurers.

Q D5. What documents do I need for a motor insurance claim?

A Documents vary by claim type: **For Own Damage Claim:** Claim form (submitted via Acko app — digitally); vehicle RC copy; valid driving licence of driver at time of incident; FIR copy (if third party involved or major accident); 6+ damage photographs; original repair bills and receipts (for reimbursement only — garage submits for cashless). **Additional for Theft Claim:** FIR copy; all vehicle keys (originals — mandatory surrender); Non-Traceable Certificate (after 90 days); Form 28, 29, 30 (vehicle transfer forms); NOC from bank/financier (if vehicle under loan); Form 26 (RTO intimation). **Additional for Third Party Claims:** FIR copy; third party's contact and vehicle details; MACT notice if received. **For Total Loss:** Same as above + signed consent for vehicle title transfer.

Q D6. Can I choose any garage in India for car repairs?

A Yes — you can use any garage in India. But the process and out-of-pocket cost differ: **Acko Network Garage (Cashless):** Acko settles the garage bill directly. You pay only the deductible (INR 1,000–2,000 for cars) and any non-covered amounts. 5,500+ garages across India. Find nearest on Acko app. In eligible cities: free vehicle pickup and drop. **Non-Network Garage (Reimbursement):** You pay the full garage bill. Submit bills to Acko (via app) within 30 days of repairs. Acko processes and reimburses the admissible amount within 7–14 working days. Must inform Acko BEFORE commencing repairs — unreported repairs risk partial or no reimbursement. **Tips for non-network garage:** Get itemised bills with part numbers; request a job card; collect all original invoices; keep payment receipts.

Q D7. How does the Acko AI photo-based claim assessment work?

A Acko's AI claims system is designed to fast-track minor motor damage claims: **How it works:** (1) You upload 6 guided photos via the Acko app — front, rear, left side, right side, close-up of damaged area, and odometer/dashboard. (2) Acko's computer vision AI analyses each photo to identify: which parts are damaged; whether they need repair or replacement; estimated repair/replacement cost based on standard rates for your car make/model/city; whether the damage pattern is consistent with the reported incident. (3) For minor damage within the AI's assessed parameters, approval is issued automatically — often within 30–60 minutes. (4) For major damage, ambiguous cases, or high-value claims, a human specialist reviews the AI's output and may dispatch a physical surveyor. **When does AI assessment fail?** Poor photo quality, dark or blurry images, photos not showing the full damage extent — all of these can delay AI processing. Take clear, well-lit photos for fastest settlement.

Q D8. How do I track my claim status after filing?

A Acko provides real-time claim tracking via multiple channels: **Acko App (Best):** Home → My Claims → Select your active claim. View: current status; last action taken; next step; estimated timeline. Status stages shown: Registered → Under Review → Survey Scheduled → Approved → Repair in Progress → Settled/Payment Transferred. **Email Notifications:** Automated emails at each major milestone — registration confirmation, survey appointment, approval, settlement. **WhatsApp (Opt-in):** Real-time WhatsApp updates at each stage — opt in via Acko app settings. **Claim Reference Number (CRN):** Issued at registration — quote this in all communication with Acko. For health claims: track pre-auth status, enhancement approvals, and final settlement via the same app-based claim tracker.

Q D9. What is a Motor Accidents Claims Tribunal (MACT) and how does it affect me?

A MACT is a court established under the Motor Vehicles Act to adjudicate Third Party injury and death claims from road accidents. **When MACT is invoked:** When a road accident results in Third Party death or serious bodily injury and the parties cannot settle amicably. The injured person or their family files a claim petition before MACT. **Acko's role:** Acko (as your TP insurer) is a named party in MACT proceedings. Acko's legal team defends the case and ultimately pays the MACT award — there is NO monetary cap on Third Party bodily injury liability. MACT awards for young, high-earning fatality victims can be INR 50 lakhs to several crores. All of this is covered by Acko's TP section. **Your responsibilities:** Inform Acko of any MACT notice received; cooperate with Acko's legal team; do not make any admission of liability or settlement without Acko's written consent.

Q D10. What is an Insurance Surveyor and when does Acko send one?

A An IRDAI-licensed surveyor is a professional loss assessor appointed by Acko to physically inspect and assess the extent of damage to the insured vehicle. **When Acko sends a surveyor:** For all claims above INR 75,000 (IRDAI mandates a surveyor for claims above this threshold); complex major damage (multiple areas of the vehicle affected); suspected fraud or inconsistency between the claim description and photo evidence; total loss assessment; when the AI photo assessment is inconclusive. **For minor claims below INR 75,000:** Acko's AI photo assessment typically replaces the physical survey — faster and more convenient for the policyholder. **Survey timeline:** Surveyor typically contacts the policyholder within 24 hours of claim registration and visits within 48 hours. Vehicle should not be repaired before the surveyor's inspection for major damage claims.

SECTION E — NO CLAIM BONUS (NCB) — COMPLETE GUIDE

Q E1. What is NCB and how much can I save?

A NCB (No Claim Bonus) is a discount on your Own Damage motor insurance premium earned for each consecutive year without an OD claim. Schedule: 0% (new policy) → 20% (1 year) → 25% (2 years) → 35% (3 years) → 45% (4 years) → 50% (5+ years — maximum). **Savings example on INR 15,000 OD premium:** 1 year NCB: save INR 3,000; 3 years: save INR 5,250; 5+ years: save INR 7,500. Over 5 years without a claim: cumulative NCB savings can exceed INR 20,000–30,000. NCB applies ONLY to the OD premium — not to TP premium or Personal Accident cover. **Small claims cost more than the repair:** Filing a INR 10,000 minor claim when you have 50% NCB means you lose INR 7,500/year in NCB savings for multiple years — the total NCB loss often far exceeds the claim amount.

Q E2. Does making a Third Party claim affect my NCB?

A No — Third Party (TP) claims have absolutely NO impact on your NCB. NCB is exclusively linked to Own Damage (OD) section claims. This means: If your car damages someone else's vehicle and you file a TP claim = NCB unaffected. If your car is damaged in an accident where the other driver is at fault and you file on TP (their policy) = NCB unaffected. Compulsory Personal Accident (CPA) claims = NCB unaffected. **The only thing that affects NCB:** Making an OD claim where your own vehicle is repaired or replaced using your own insurance. Even a INR 500 OD claim resets NCB to 0% unless NCB Protection add-on is active.

Q E3. I just made a claim and lost my NCB. How do I rebuild it?

A After an OD claim, your NCB resets to 0% at the next renewal. Rebuilding: Year 1 without a claim: 20% NCB. Year 2: 25%. Year 3: 35%. Year 4: 45%. Year 5: 50%. **Strategy to rebuild faster:** For small repairs (under INR 15,000–20,000 for cars with high NCB), pay out of pocket rather than claim — the NCB loss usually costs more over time than the repair. Buy NCB Protection add-on before making any future claim — protects the NCB you rebuild. **If you switch insurers:** Request an NCB certificate from Acko (issued in 3 working days; valid 90 days) and use it with the new insurer — your NCB is portable.

Q E4. How do I transfer my NCB when I buy a new car?

A NCB is linked to YOU — not your vehicle. When you sell your old car and buy a new one: **Step 1:** Do not cancel your old policy before getting the NCB certificate. **Step 2:** Contact Acko via app → My Policies → NCB Certificate → Request. Certificate issued within 3 working days. **Step 3:** NCB certificate states your name, old vehicle, current NCB percentage, and validity (90 days). **Step 4:** When buying insurance for your new car, provide this NCB certificate to Acko (or any insurer). The NCB discount is applied to the new car's OD premium from Day 1. **Important:** The certificate is valid for 90 days from issue. If you don't buy a new car within 90 days, request a fresh certificate closer to your purchase date.

Q E5. What is NCB Protection add-on and is it worth it?

A NCB Protection add-on allows you to make ONE Own Damage claim per policy year without losing your accumulated NCB at renewal. **Value calculation:** You have 50% NCB on a INR 15,000 OD premium (saving INR 7,500/year). You make one OD claim. Without NCB Protection: NCB drops to 0% → next year premium goes from INR 7,500 (after NCB) to INR 15,000 → additional cost INR 7,500/year for multiple years. With NCB Protection: NCB stays at 50% → next year premium remains INR 7,500. NCB Protection typically costs INR 800–1,500/year. If you make even one claim, it saves INR 5,000–7,500+ in premium. **ROI:** Even if you never claim, the premium for NCB Protection is modest compared to the NCB you protect.

Q E6. What happens to NCB if I don't renew my policy on time?

A NCB and the 90-day rule: If you renew BEFORE expiry: NCB preserved in full at the earned level. If you renew WITHIN 90 days of expiry (break-in renewal): NCB is still preserved — you don't lose it even with a short lapse. If you renew AFTER 90 days from expiry: NCB is permanently forfeited — it resets to 0% and there is NO way to recover it. **The message is clear:** Set a calendar reminder 30 days before your policy expiry. Acko sends SMS and app notifications at 45, 30, 15, and 7 days before expiry — respond to them. Letting a 50% NCB lapse due to missed renewal costs thousands of rupees in higher premiums for years. When in doubt, renew early.

Q E7. Can NCB be shared between family members or vehicles?

A No — NCB cannot be shared between family members. Each policyholder builds their own NCB independently: husband and wife each have their own NCB on their respective vehicles; parent cannot transfer their NCB to a child's vehicle; employer cannot transfer NCB to an employee. **NCB is transferable by ONE policyholder to ONE new vehicle.** If you own two cars and insure both with Acko, each car has its own independent NCB accumulation — they do not aggregate. **Hypothetical:** If you sell both cars and buy one new car, you can only use the NCB certificate from ONE of the sold vehicles — not both combined.

SECTION F — ADD-ON COVERS — MOTOR AND HEALTH

Q F1. Which motor insurance add-ons are most important? How do I prioritise?

A Prioritisation depends on your car's age and your city: **For new cars (0–3 years) in metro cities:** Must-have: Zero Depreciation (prevents 30–50% deduction on parts); Engine and Gearbox Protection (INR 1–5 lakh engine damage from flooding excluded without it). Strongly recommended: NCB Protection; RSA (Roadside Assistance). Consider: RTI (Return to Invoice) for gap protection. **For cars 3–5 years old:** Zero Dep still valuable; Engine Protection essential if in flood-prone city; NCB Protection if you have 35%+ NCB. **For older cars (5+ years):** Zero Dep no longer available (5-year limit); Engine Protection still valuable; RSA for breakdown help; Key Protection for modern smart keys. **For all ages in Delhi:** NCB Protection is critical given high theft/accident rate.

Q F2. What exactly does the Engine and Gearbox Protection add-on cover?

A Standard OD policies exclude engine damage from 'consequential' causes — particularly: water entering the engine (hydrostatic lock) when driving through flooded roads, resulting in bent connecting rods, damaged pistons, broken valves; engine damage from oil starvation when the sump is punctured in an accident but the driver continues to drive; gearbox damage from lubricant leakage following an accident impact on the gearbox casing. The Engine and Gearbox Protection add-on REMOVES these exclusions and covers: hydrostatic lock repair; internal engine component replacement (pistons, valves, con-rods, camshaft); gearbox overhaul after lubricant leak from an insured accident; differential/transfer case damage from lubricant loss after accident. **Repair costs it covers:** Engine overhaul: INR 80,000–3,50,000 depending on car and damage extent. Without this add-on, these costs are entirely out-of-pocket.

Q F3. Is Zero Depreciation worth it for a 4-year-old car?

A At 4 years old: Applicable depreciation on IDV = 40% (i.e., your car's insured value is already 60% of original). On parts replacement: plastic and rubber components attract 50% depreciation deduction. Bumper replacement: if the bumper costs INR 8,000 (original), without Zero Dep Acko pays INR 4,000 (after 50% plastic depreciation). With Zero Dep: Acko pays INR 8,000. **For a 4-year-old car:** Zero Dep is still worth it IF the car has expensive plastic body parts (premium cars, SUVs) and you're in a high-accident area. For inexpensive hatchbacks in smaller cities, the add-on premium may exceed the depreciation savings. **Calculation:** If Zero Dep add-on costs INR 2,500/year and you expect to make claims with plastic part replacements totalling over INR 5,000 in depreciation deduction, it's worth it. Zero Dep is NOT available for vehicles above 5 years.

Q F4. How does Return to Invoice (RTI) compare to standard total loss settlement?

A RTI is the gap filler between IDV (what standard insurance pays) and the original cost (what you paid). **Without RTI:** Car bought for INR 12 lakhs on-road; after 2 years, IDV = INR 9.6 lakhs (80% of ex-showroom). Total loss → Acko pays INR 9.6 lakhs. You need INR 12+ lakhs to buy the same car new. Gap: INR 2.4+ lakhs. **With RTI:** Acko pays the original on-road price — INR 12 lakhs minus deductible. Gap: essentially zero. **RTI premium:** Typically INR 1,500–3,000/year for a INR 10 lakh car. One total loss claim saves INR 2–4 lakhs compared to standard settlement. **When RTI is NOT worth it:** If the car is above 3 years old (RTI not available anyway); if the car's market resale value is close to IDV; if the total loss risk is low (rural area, short commutes, garaged car).

Q F5. What does Roadside Assistance (RSA) cover? When should I call?

A **RSA covers 6 key services:** (1) Towing: tow your vehicle to the nearest Acko network garage or repair shop — free up to 50 km; beyond 50 km, you pay the difference. (2) Flat tyre change: technician arrives and changes flat tyre using your spare. If no spare, arranges nearest tyre shop. (3) Emergency fuel delivery: fuel delivered to your location (you pay for the fuel, delivery is free). (4) Battery jump-start: booster cables used to jump-start a flat battery. If battery needs replacement, arrange that separately. (5) Key lockout assistance: locksmith dispatched if you're locked out. (6) Minor on-site repair: small roadside fixes up to INR 1,500 in value. **When to call RSA:** Tyre blowout on highway; battery dead in parking lot; car stalls mid-journey; key locked inside car. Average response time: 30–45 minutes in cities, 60–90 minutes on highways.

Q F6. Are there any add-ons for health insurance that are worth buying?

A Yes — two key health insurance add-ons to consider: **(1) Maternity Add-on (Platinum plan only):** Covers normal and C-section delivery, pre-natal and post-natal care, newborn hospitalisation. 24-month waiting period applies from add-on inclusion. If you're planning a family: add this to your Platinum plan 2 years before planned pregnancy. Delivery costs in Tier-1 cities: INR 60,000–1,50,000 (normal) to INR 1,50,000–3,00,000 (C-section). Worth it if you plan to have children. **(2) OPD Add-on (select plans):** Covers outpatient consultations, diagnostic tests, and pharmacy bills up to an annual limit (INR 10,000–25,000). Adds significantly to premium. Worth it for: frequent OPD visits; chronic condition management; families with young children who visit doctors often. **Bariatric Surgery Add-on:** If you have significant obesity (BMI 35+) and are considering weight-loss surgery — buy this add-on now and serve the 36-month wait.

Q F7. Can I add or remove add-ons during the policy year (not at renewal)?

A For motor insurance: Some add-ons CAN be added mid-year as an endorsement (with pro-rata additional premium for the remaining policy period). This includes: RSA; Zero Depreciation (on Acko's discretion — check app); Engine Protection; Key Protection. Some add-ons cannot be added mid-year — particularly: NCB Protection (must be at inception/renewal); RTI. Removing add-ons mid-year: possible with a proportionate premium refund, but not recommended. **For health insurance:** Add-ons generally cannot be modified mid-year — they can only be added or changed at the time of annual renewal. Maternity add-on, if not included at inception, starts the 24-month waiting period only from the renewal date when it's added. **Best practice:** Review your add-on requirements annually at renewal — it's the easiest time to make changes.

SECTION G — RENEWALS, PORTABILITY AND POLICY MANAGEMENT

Q G1. How do I renew my Acko car insurance policy? Step-by-step.

A **Step 1:** Open Acko app or visit acko.com. Log in with registered mobile number (OTP verification). **Step 2:** Go to My Policies. Your expiring policy is shown prominently with an expiry countdown. **Step 3:** Tap 'Renew Policy'. Review pre-filled information — make corrections if needed: update vehicle details (any modifications added?); update personal details (address change?); review and confirm NCB percentage; add/remove add-ons as needed; adjust IDV. **Step 4:** Review the final premium breakdown (OD + TP + Add-ons + GST). **Step 5:** Pay via UPI, net banking, or card. **Step 6:** Receive renewed policy certificate instantly via email and Acko app. **Best time to renew:** 7–14 days before expiry to avoid any gap. Acko sends reminders at 45, 30, 15, and 7 days before expiry.

Q G2. What happens to my coverage if I don't renew before the policy expires?

A From the moment of expiry until renewal: **Zero coverage** — no TP and no OD protection. Driving is illegal under the MV Act. If you're in an accident during a lapsed period: you bear 100% of all Third Party liability personally (this can be crores in a fatality case); no OD coverage for your own car's damage. **Grace period (health insurance):** 30 days after expiry — no coverage during these 30 days, but renewal is possible and waiting period credits are preserved. **Break-in motor insurance renewal:** If lapsed, your car needs physical inspection before Acko reinstates OD coverage. Within 90 days: inspection + renewal. Beyond 90 days: NCB permanently forfeited. **Bottom line:** Renew before expiry. The 5 minutes it takes to renew on the app is vastly preferable to the legal and financial consequences of driving uninsured.

Q G3. How do I cancel my Acko insurance policy and get a refund?

A Cancellation process: **Via Acko app:** My Policies → Select policy → More Options → Cancel Policy → Confirm cancellation reason. **Via email:** Write to hello@acko.com with policy number and reason for cancellation. **Refund calculation — Motor Insurance:** Calculated on short-rate basis (slightly lower than pro-rata to account for administrative costs). If no claim has been made: refund = premium for unexpired period × short-rate factor (per IRDAI table). If a claim has been made and admitted: typically no refund. **Health Insurance:** Free look period (first 15 days of new policy): full refund minus stamp duty and proportionate premium for days covered. After free look: pro-rata refund for unexpired period minus any claims paid. **Note:** TP premium refund for the cancelled period is processed separately at pro-rata rates.

Q G4. How do I add a family member to my health insurance policy?

A **During policy year (endorsement):** Adding a newborn baby born during the policy period — inform Acko within 90 days of birth via app. Adding a newly married spouse — within 30 days of marriage. The new member's coverage starts from the endorsement effective date. Fresh waiting periods may apply to the new member (they haven't served any waiting period). Pro-rata additional premium is charged for the remaining policy period. **At renewal:** Easiest time to add or remove family members — no timing constraints; waiting periods are clarified upfront; premium is recalculated for the new family composition. **Removing a member:** Possible via endorsement (death, children turning 26, divorce) or at renewal. Proportionate premium refund is provided.

Q G5. Can I change my coverage type or sum insured during the policy year?

A **For motor insurance:** Upgrading from TP Only to Comprehensive mid-year requires cancellation of the TP-only policy and issuance of a new Comprehensive policy — effectively a fresh policy with a new inception date. Changing IDV mid-year is possible via endorsement for certain reasons (vehicle modification, incorrect IDV declaration). **For health insurance:** Increasing Sum Insured during the year is generally not allowed for existing coverage — fresh waiting periods would apply for the incremental amount and it's administratively complex. **Best time to change:** At renewal. You can change plan variant, sum insured, add-ons, and co-payment options cleanly at renewal with full transparency.

Q G6. How do I download my Acko policy document or insurance certificate?

A Your Acko policy documents are available 24x7 digitally — no physical copy needed: **Via Acko App:** My Policies → Select policy → Tap 'View Policy' → Download PDF. Policy document and Certificate of Insurance are both downloadable. **Via Email:** Policy document emailed immediately on purchase/renewal to registered email. Check spam if not received. **Via Acko Website:** acko.com → Login → My Account → My Policies → Download. **For traffic police checks:** The digital Certificate of Insurance on your phone app is legally valid under the IT Act 2000 and IRDAI guidelines — no physical copy required. **For bank/loan purposes:** Download and share the PDF from the app. Banks accept digital policy documents for vehicle loan requirements.

Q G7. What is Health Insurance Portability and how does it work?

A Portability is your right to switch health insurance companies at renewal without losing the waiting period credits you've accumulated. **Why port to Acko?** Better coverage terms (e.g., Acko Platinum's zero co-pay vs competitor's 20%); lower premiums for equivalent coverage; digital-first hassle-free claims; better network hospital coverage in your area. **Porting process:** (1) Submit portability request to Acko minimum 45 days before current policy expires. (2) Acko has 15 working days to process and respond. (3) Provide: last 3 years' policy documents; claim history; Acko proposal form. (4) Acko may request additional medical reports for underwriting. (5) On acceptance: Acko issues the new policy from the day after your current policy expires. (6) Waiting period credits from previous insurer fully transfer. **IRDAI rule:** Acko cannot refuse a portability request without valid underwriting reasons.

Q G8. How do I request an NCB certificate from Acko?

A An NCB (No Claim Bonus) certificate is needed when: you sell your car and want to use your NCB on a new car; you switch motor insurers; you want documented proof of your claim-free years. **How to request:** Acko App → My Policies → Select motor policy → Documents → Request NCB Certificate. OR email hello@acko.com with your policy number and request. **Processing time:** 3 working days (typically faster). **What the certificate contains:** Your name; old vehicle registration number; current NCB percentage; policy number; date of issue; Acko's official signature. **Validity:** 90 days from date of issue. If your new vehicle purchase is delayed, request the certificate closer to the actual purchase date.

SECTION H — PREMIUMS, DISCOUNTS AND PAYMENT OPTIONS

Q H1. What payment methods does Acko accept for insurance premiums?

A Acko accepts all major digital payment methods — no cash or cheque: **UPI:** All UPI apps including Google Pay, PhonePe, Paytm, BHIM, Amazon Pay, ICICI iMobile, HDFC PayZapp, and any bank's UPI. **Net Banking:** All major Indian banks — SBI, HDFC, ICICI, Axis, Kotak, PNB, Bank of Baroda, Canara Bank, and 50+ others. **Credit Card:** Visa, Mastercard, American Express, Rupay — all major issuers. **Debit Card:** All Visa/Mastercard/Rupay debit cards. **EMI:** Credit card EMI options (3, 6, or 9 months) available for premium above INR 5,000 on select credit cards — bank interest charges apply. **Acko Wallet:** Pre-loaded digital wallet. All transactions are encrypted and secure. Instant payment confirmation. No additional fee for any payment method.

Q H2. What discounts are available on Acko car insurance?

A Acko offers several legitimate discounts on the Own Damage premium: (1) **No Claim Bonus (NCB):** 20%–50% discount for consecutive claim-free years — the biggest discount available. (2) **Voluntary Deductible:** Choosing to bear INR 2,500 → ~5% OD discount; INR 5,000 → ~10%; INR 10,000 → ~20%; INR 15,000 → up to 25%. Higher deductible = lower premium but higher out-of-pocket at claim time. (3) **ARAI Anti-Theft Device:** 2.5% OD discount for certified ARAI-approved anti-theft device installation. (4) **AAI Membership:** 5% OD discount for Automobile Association of India members. **Note:** Multiple discounts can be combined. NCB + voluntary deductible + AAI membership = significant cumulative saving.

Q H3. Why does Acko's premium differ from other insurers for the same car?

A Motor insurance OD premiums are de-tariffed — meaning insurers can price them based on their own underwriting models. Premium differences arise from: (1) **Acko's direct model:** No agent commissions (15–20% of premium at traditional insurers) → savings passed to customers as lower premiums. (2) **Claims experience:** Acko's OD rate may differ based on its AI-assessed claims data for your vehicle make/model/city. (3) **Add-on pricing:** Add-on rates differ between insurers — compare the full quote including add-ons. (4) **IDV offered:** Some insurers offer artificially low IDV to show lower premium — lower IDV means lower payout on total loss. Compare like-for-like IDV. (5) **Administrative efficiency:** Acko's digital-only model has lower operating costs → lower premium. **Always compare:** Same IDV, same add-ons, same deductible.

Q H4. Does filing a claim increase my premium at the next renewal?

A Under IRDAI regulations: insurers CANNOT load (increase) individual premiums specifically because of your claim history on a personal motor or health policy. However, there is a significant indirect effect: **NCB Loss:** If you file an OD claim, you lose your accumulated NCB at renewal. Example: 50% NCB on INR 15,000 OD premium = you pay INR 7,500 (after NCB). Post-claim (0% NCB) = you pay INR 15,000 → effectively doubling your OD premium. This is not a 'loading' — it's the removal of the NCB discount you earned by not claiming. **For health insurance:** IRDAI explicitly prohibits individual premium loading based on claim history. Premium increases for health are only allowed for age-band progression or IRDAI-approved product-level revisions.

Q H5. Can I pay health insurance premium in monthly instalments?

A Traditionally, health insurance premiums were collected annually. IRDAI has progressively relaxed this: **Quarterly payment:** Acko offers quarterly premium payment options for annual health policies on select plans — you pay 1/4 of the annual premium each quarter. A slight loading (additional charge) applies for quarterly vs annual. **Monthly payment:** Not widely available for individual health plans — check Acko app for current options. **For corporate / group insurance:** Monthly deduction from salary is common. **Credit card EMI:** Pay the annual health premium via credit card and avail 3/6/9 month EMI from the bank (bank interest charges apply; Acko receives the full amount). **Recommendation:** Annual payment in full is typically cheapest. Use EMI only if cash flow is constrained.

Q H6. What is GST on insurance premium? Can I claim it as tax deduction?

A **GST on Insurance:** 18% GST applies to all insurance premiums — motor (OD and add-ons), health, and life. TP motor premium is exempt from GST (as it is a government-mandated pool). **Tax deductions on insurance premium: Health insurance premium:** Deductible under Section 80D of the Income Tax Act: INR 25,000/year for self, spouse, and dependent children (below 60 years); additional INR 25,000 for parents below 60; additional INR 50,000 if parents are senior citizens (60+ years). Maximum total deduction: INR 1 lakh (if both self and parents are senior citizens). GST paid on health insurance premium is also included in the deductible amount. **Motor insurance premium:** NOT eligible for 80D deduction. However, if the car is used for business purposes, motor insurance premium can be claimed as a business expense under Section 37.

SECTION I — DIGITAL SERVICES AND ACKO APP

Q I1. What all can I do on the Acko app?

A The Acko app is your complete insurance lifecycle management tool: **Buy:** Purchase new car, bike, health, travel, and other insurance products. **Renew:** Renew any expiring policy with pre-filled information — takes 2 minutes. **View & Download:** All policy documents and certificates available anytime. **File Claims:** Register motor and health claims with guided photo capture and document upload. **Track Claims:** Real-time claim status with milestone notifications. **Find Garages/Hospitals:** Locate nearest Acko cashless network garage or hospital. **NCB Certificate:** Request and download your NCB certificate for vehicle transfer. **Add Endorsements:** Request mid-year policy changes. **Support:** Chat with Acko's AI support or escalate to human agent. **Health Card:** Access digital health card for cashless hospitalisation. **Annual Health Check-up:** Book your annual check-up at empanelled diagnostic centres. Available on Google Play Store and Apple App Store.

Q I2. Is the digital policy document legally valid?

A Yes — digital policy documents and Certificates of Insurance issued by Acko are legally valid under: (1) The Information Technology Act, 2000 — electronic records and digital documents are legally equivalent to physical documents. (2) IRDAI's e-insurance guidelines — electronic policy issuance and storage are explicitly permitted. (3) Motor Vehicles Amendment Act, 2019 — digital display of insurance certificate on mobile phone is acceptable to traffic police. **When physical copy might still be preferred:** Old-generation RTO offices; some private bank loan documentation; court submissions (a printed copy may be preferred). **Acko's position:** All Acko policies are issued digitally — no physical copy is dispatched by default. If a physical copy is specifically required, Acko can post a printed copy on request.

Q I3. How does Acko protect my personal and insurance data?

A Acko takes data protection seriously and complies with India's Digital Personal Data Protection Act 2023 (DPDPA) and the Information Technology Act 2000. Key measures: **Encryption:** All data in transit uses TLS 1.3; data at rest encrypted using AES-256. **Access control:** Health data (sensitive personal data under DPDPA) is accessible only to authorised claims and underwriting personnel on a need-to-know basis. **No marketing use of health data:** Your health declarations and claim history are never shared with advertisers or third-party marketers. **Third-party sharing:** Data shared only with: IRDAI and statutory regulators as required; TPA and network hospitals for claims processing; reinsurers for risk management — all under contractual data protection obligations. **Your rights under DPDPA:** Right to access your data; right to correction of inaccuracies; right to erasure (subject to regulatory retention requirements).

Q I4. Can I buy Acko insurance if I am an NRI (Non-Resident Indian)?

A For motor insurance: You can purchase Acko motor insurance if you own a vehicle registered in India, even if you are an NRI. The vehicle must be registered in India and used on Indian roads. An Indian contact address and mobile number are required for policy issuance. For health insurance: Acko health insurance is primarily designed for Indian residents. If you are an NRI residing outside India for more than 180 days in a year, coverage may be limited to hospitalisation in India only — international hospitalisation is excluded. For NRIs who want international coverage: consider Acko's travel insurance or a global health plan. **Payment:** Premium can be paid from NRI bank accounts (NRO, NRE) via online banking or international credit/debit cards. UPI may require an Indian mobile number linked to the bank account.

Q I5. How do I contact Acko for help? All support channels.

A Acko offers multiple support channels — all digital, no physical branch visits: **Acko App:** My Account → Support → Chat. AI chatbot handles common queries 24x7; human agent available during business hours. Fastest response for routine queries. **Website Chat:** acko.com → Help → Chat. Same AI + human agent system. **Email:** For motor claims: claims@acko.com; for health claims: healthclaims@acko.com; for general queries: hello@acko.com; for grievances: grievance@acko.com. Response within 24–48 hours. **For IRDAI escalation:** If Acko doesn't resolve your grievance in 15 working days: IRDAI IGMS portal: igms.irda.gov.in; IRDAI consumer helpline: 155255 (toll-free). **For independent resolution:** Insurance Ombudsman: www.cioins.co.in — 17 offices across India. Free service for claims disputes up to INR 30 lakhs.

SECTION J — LEGAL, REGULATORY AND GENERAL QUERIES

Q J1. Is Acko a legitimate insurance company? How do I verify?

A Yes — Acko General Insurance Limited is fully licensed and regulated by IRDAI (Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India). Verification: **IRDAI Registration:** Acko is registered as a Non-Life (General) Insurer with IRDAI. You can verify at irdai.gov.in under 'Registered Insurers'. **Corporate details:** CIN: U66000MH2016PLC287385; Registered Office: Lotus Corporate Park, Mumbai. **Acko is publicly known:** Founded in 2016; backed by major investors; partner with Amazon, Google, Ola, and other platforms for embedded insurance; featured in mainstream financial media. **Digital first:** Acko operates without physical branches — this is a business model choice (like online banks), not a red flag. All policies are IRDAI-regulated and your claims rights are protected by law.

Q J2. What is the Insurance Ombudsman and how do I approach them?

A The Insurance Ombudsman is a quasi-judicial authority established by IRDAI under the Insurance Ombudsman Rules 2017. It provides free, independent resolution of insurance disputes. **Who can approach:** Any individual policyholder (not corporates) whose dispute with an insurer remains unresolved. **For what disputes:** Repudiation (rejection) of claims; delays in claim settlement; partial claim settlement; premium disputes; policy servicing complaints. **Monetary limit:** Claims disputes up to INR 30 lakhs. **How to approach:** Visit www.cioins.co.in → Find the ombudsman for your state → Submit written complaint with all documents and previous correspondence with Acko. **Timeline:** Ombudsman aims to resolve within 30–90 days. **Binding award:** Ombudsman's award is binding on the insurer (Acko). You can choose to accept or reject it.

Q J3. Can Acko cancel my policy without my consent?

A Acko can cancel a policy under specific, legally defined circumstances: **Motor Insurance — valid grounds for Acko cancellation:** Fraud or material misrepresentation in the proposal (e.g., hiding prior accidents, DUI convictions); non-payment of premium after the grace period; change in risk profile that was not disclosed (e.g., using personal car for commercial taxi without declaration). **Health Insurance:** Fraud or misrepresentation of medical history; non-payment of premium. **Acko CANNOT cancel for:** Making too many claims; having an expensive or complicated claim history; commercial reasons unrelated to misrepresentation. **Notice required:** 15 days written notice before cancellation. Premium for the remaining period is refunded on pro-rata basis. **What you can do:** If you believe the cancellation is improper, raise a grievance with Acko and subsequently with IRDAI.

Q J4. What is Utmost Good Faith (UGF) in insurance? Why does it matter?

A Utmost Good Faith (uberrimae fidei) is the founding legal principle of all insurance contracts. It means both parties — Acko and you — are legally obligated to disclose all material facts truthfully and completely. **Why it matters:** If you hide or misrepresent any material fact at the time of proposal (e.g., hiding that your car was already damaged, hiding a pre-existing heart condition for health insurance), Acko has the right to void the policy from inception and reject all claims — even if you've been paying premiums for years. **Common violations and consequences:** Hiding prior accidents on motor policy proposal → theft claim rejected (policy void); hiding diabetes on health proposal → cardiac surgery claim rejected (unrelated to diabetes, but policy void); claiming flood damage was an accident (misrepresentation of claim) → criminal fraud charges possible. **The solution:** Always disclose everything. Disclosed pre-existing conditions are covered after the waiting period — undisclosed ones are never covered.

Q J5. What is the Free Look Period and when can I use it?

A The Free Look Period gives you a window to review your insurance policy after purchase and return it if you're not satisfied. **Duration:** 15 days from the date of receipt of the Policy Document (30 days for policies sold entirely through distance marketing — email, phone, or online without face-to-face interaction). **Available for:** New policies only — not for renewals or endorsements. **How to use it:** Read the policy document carefully — check coverage, exclusions, waiting periods, sub-limits, room rent limits, and co-payment conditions. If any term is unacceptable, inform Acko within the free look period: via Acko app → My Policy → Request Cancellation (Free Look) → Submit reason. **Refund:** Full premium refund minus: stamp duty; proportionate premium for days of coverage already provided; cost of any medical examination conducted. **Advice:** Use the free look period seriously — don't just buy and ignore. Read what you've purchased.

Q J6. How does the IRDAI Integrated Grievance Management System (IGMS) work?

A IGMS (igms.irda.gov.in) is IRDAI's online platform for policyholders to register and track complaints against any IRDAI-licensed insurer including Acko. **When to use IGMS:** If Acko does not resolve your grievance within 15 working days of formal complaint submission; if you are unsatisfied with Acko's resolution and want regulatory oversight. **How to file:** Visit igms.irda.gov.in → Register/Login → File Complaint → Enter policy details and grievance description → Upload supporting documents → Submit. **What happens after:** IGMS routes the complaint to Acko; Acko is required to respond via IGMS within 15 working days; IRDAI monitors response rates. Acko's response rate and resolution quality are tracked by IRDAI as part of insurer performance metrics. **IRDAI Consumer Helpline:** 155255 (toll-free) — for guidance on how to file an IGMS complaint or for status updates.

Q J7. What is a Surveyor's Role and can I dispute the surveyor's assessment?

A An IRDAI-licensed surveyor is a professional loss assessor who physically inspects damaged vehicles (for motor claims above INR 75,000) to assess the nature, extent, and cost of damage. **Surveyor's role:** Inspect the vehicle; review repair estimates from the garage; assess whether damage is consistent with the reported cause; determine whether it's partial loss or total loss; prepare a survey report that forms the basis of Acko's claim settlement decision. **Can you dispute the assessment?** Yes. If you believe the surveyor's assessment is incorrect: request a copy of the survey report from Acko; submit counter-evidence — additional photographs, second repair estimates from another authorised garage, technical expert opinion. **Right to second survey:** Under IRDAI regulations, if you dispute the settlement amount, you can request a second assessment by another IRDAI-licensed surveyor. The cost of the second survey is borne by Acko. The second assessment is provided to the Ombudsman if the dispute escalates.

QUICK REFERENCE — KEY NUMBERS AND CONTACTS

Service	Details	When to Use
Acko App Claims	My Policies → File a Claim	First step for all motor and health claims
Motor Claims Email	claims@acko.com	For complex motor claim documentation
Health Claims Email	healthclaims@acko.com	For health pre-auth queries and reimbursement
General Support	hello@acko.com | Acko app chat	Policy queries, endorsements, documents
Grievance	grievance@acko.com	Formal complaints — Acko responds in 15 working days
Network Garage Locator	Acko app → Find Garage	Before taking car for cashless repair
Network Hospital Locator	Acko app → Find Hospital	Before cashless hospitalisation
Acko Website	www.acko.com	Purchase, renew, manage all policies
IRDAI IGMS Portal	igms.irda.gov.in	Escalate unresolved grievances to regulator
IRDAI Consumer Helpline	155255 (toll-free)	Regulatory guidance and complaint filing help
Insurance Ombudsman	www.cioins.co.in	Independent dispute resolution — free service
Consumer Forum	edaakhil.nic.in	Consumer court online filing for larger disputes

SECTION K — COMPREHENSIVE CLAIM SCENARIOS

Q K1. My car hit a cow on the highway at night. What claim process applies and what is covered?

A Animal strikes on Indian roads are common — cattle, dogs, and wildlife on national highways are a significant cause of accidents. Coverage and process: (1) YOUR CAR DAMAGE: Fully covered under OD — Accidental External Means (animal collision is treated as accidental damage). Register claim on Acko app. (2) FIR: Not mandatory for animal collision (no third party involved, no person injured). A police complaint/GD is helpful documentation. (3) AI ASSESSMENT: Upload photos — Acko AI assesses bumper, grille, headlights, bonnet for damage. Minor claims approved quickly. (4) ANIMAL WELFARE: The animal's owner (if identified) has no insurance liability under standard motor insurance. (5) NIGHT DRIVING NOTE: Reduced visibility does not affect claim admissibility — accidents caused by poor visibility are still covered. (6) Zero Dep: If active, full part replacement without depreciation. Bumper and grille are plastic parts — 50% depreciation without Zero Dep.

Q K2. My car was vandalized in a parking lot — scratches all over. How do I claim?

A Vandalism by a third party falls under the OD section — Malicious Acts by Third Parties. Here's the full process: (1) FILE POLICE COMPLAINT: A police General Diary (GD) entry or FIR is required as evidence that damage was caused by malicious act, not an accident. This is important — without police documentation, Acko cannot verify the cause of the scratches. (2) REGISTER CLAIM on Acko app. Mention "vandalism" as cause. Upload photos — close-ups of each scratch/dent. (3) SURVEYOR: A physical surveyor may be dispatched for widespread damage. For a single-area scratch, AI assessment may suffice. (4) SETTLEMENT: Full body repaint cost is admissible minus 50% on paint material (standard policy) or full cost (Zero Dep). Metal panel repair is at full cost. (5) NCB IMPACT: Making this claim resets NCB — consider paying out of pocket for minor scratches to preserve NCB.

Q K3. I am involved in an accident involving multiple vehicles — how does the claim work?

A Multi-vehicle accidents involve multiple insurance policies and can be complex. Here is how it unfolds: (1) SAFETY FIRST, PHOTOS SECOND: After ensuring safety, photograph all vehicles involved, all number plates, the road and debris, and skid marks. (2) EXCHANGE INFORMATION: Get all parties' name, vehicle registration, insurance company, and policy number. (3) YOUR OD CLAIM: Covers your own vehicle damage regardless of who is at fault. Register with Acko regardless of fault attribution. (4) TP CLAIM against at-fault driver: If another driver caused the accident, you can claim from their TP insurer directly (or through MACT). This is separate from your OD claim. (5) AT-FAULT LIABILITY: If you caused the accident, your TP covers other parties' damage up to INR 7.5 lakhs per accident (property). Bodily injury is unlimited. (6) SHARED FAULT: In India, contributory negligence is recognized. Both parties' insurers may share liability proportionately. (7) ACKO'S ROLE: Acko handles your OD claim; Acko's legal team handles any MACT proceedings on your TP section.

Q K4. My bike was completely flooded during heavy rain in my building's basement parking. What claim do I get?

A Flood damage to a parked vehicle — whether on the road or in a basement parking lot — is covered under OD (Natural Calamity — Flood/Inundation). Here is the detailed claim picture: (1) OWN VEHICLE DAMAGE: Covered under flood/inundation peril. This includes: engine, electrical system, interiors, all mechanical components affected by water. (2) ENGINE PROTECTION ADD-ON: If water entered the engine and caused hydrostatic lock — Engine Protection add-on is needed for engine-specific coverage. Standard OD covers flood water entering cabin and electrical damage but the engine damage from water ingression is specifically covered only with Engine Protection. (3) NOT REQUIRED: FIR not needed for natural calamity claims. Simply register on Acko app, photograph the flooded bike and surrounding parking area, and document water level marks. (4) SURVEYOR: Dispatched within 24-48 hours. Do not attempt to start the bike before surveyor inspection. (5) TP (Society or Parking Owner): If building management's negligence contributed to basement flooding (inadequate waterproofing, faulty drainage), you may have a civil claim against them — separate from your insurance claim.

Q K5. I was hospitalised in an emergency at a non-network hospital in a remote area. What is the reimbursement process?

A Emergency hospitalisation at non-network hospitals is covered under the reimbursement process. Here is a detailed walkthrough: (1) ADMIT FIRST, INFORM ACKO WITHIN 24 HOURS: In a life-threatening emergency, get the best available treatment immediately. Inform Acko within 24 hours of admission via app. (2) PRE-AUTH FOR NON-NETWORK: While pre-auth is designed for network hospitals, Acko has an emergency process for non-network admissions. Contact Acko helpline and inform them — they may provide a cashless authorization letter even for non-network hospitals if it qualifies as a genuine emergency. (3) COLLECT ALL DOCUMENTS BEFORE DISCHARGE: Original bills, itemised cost breakdown, discharge summary, diagnostic reports, doctor's prescriptions, lab reports. Get the hospital's registration certificate copy. (4) SUBMIT WITHIN 30 DAYS OF DISCHARGE: Upload all documents via Acko app. (5) PROCESSING TIME: 10-20 working days from complete document submission. (6) ASSESSMENT: Acko assesses based on standard rates for the procedure in that geography — some procedures may be valued at standard rates, not actual bills if they significantly exceed norms. (7) REIMBURSEMENT: Admissible amount transferred to bank account via NEFT.

SECTION L — SPECIAL TOPICS AND EDGE CASES

Q L1. Can I insure a vintage/classic car (25+ years old) with Acko?

A Yes — Acko covers classic and vintage vehicles, though the process differs from standard policies. Key aspects: (1) IDV DETERMINATION: For vehicles above 5 years, IDV is agreed by mutual consent between you and Acko. For genuine vintage vehicles (25+ years), a specialist valuation may be required — typically done by ARAI or an approved vintage car valuer. The agreed value reflects the current market price for that specific model, not depreciated original price. (2) PREMIUM: Higher rates may apply due to: limited garage network for specialist repair; imported or custom-fabricated parts; higher theft attractiveness. (3) USAGE: Standard comprehensive cover applies for road use. If the car is used for vintage car rallies or exhibitions only, a declared-use policy with restricted mileage may offer better rates. (4) CLAIM ASSESSMENT: For vintage car claims, specialized surveyors familiar with the model assess damage. Parts that are no longer manufactured may require custom fabrication — costs assessed case by case. (5) COLLECTOR'S VALUE: Acko acknowledges that a perfectly restored 1967 Ambassador or 1958 Premier Padmini has collector's value beyond the mechanical worth — this is factored into the agreed IDV.

Q L2. I drive my private car for Ola/Uber. Is it covered under my personal insurance?

A This is one of the most important questions for gig economy drivers — and the answer is nuanced: (1) STANDARD PRIVATE CAR POLICY DOES NOT COVER COMMERCIAL USE: If you are driving for Ola/Uber, your car is being used for commercial passenger transportation. Standard personal car insurance explicitly excludes commercial use without a commercial permit. (2) WHAT HAPPENS IF YOU CLAIM: If you have an accident while actively on an Ola/Uber ride and Acko investigates, they may discover the commercial use through telematics data, the ride platform's records, or the accident report. This could result in claim repudiation. (3) THE LEGAL POSITION: Ola/Uber mandate drivers to have a commercial permit (All-India Tourist Permit or State Transport Permit) AND commercial vehicle insurance for all registered driver-partners. (4) WHAT TO DO: If you drive for Ola/Uber, get a commercial taxi permit from the RTO and purchase commercial vehicle insurance. This covers both your legal obligation and your insurance requirement. (5) NOTE: Some insurers offer personal car policies with limited taxi endorsement — check if Acko has such an option for select cities.

Q L3. My car was stolen by my family member or employee. Can I claim?

A This is a grey area involving trust, intent, and insurance law: (1) THEFT BY A STRANGER: Clear-cut theft claim — covered under the OD theft section. (2) THEFT BY KNOWN PERSON (Family member or employee): If a family member or employee takes the car without your permission and does not return it, this may be reportable as theft. However: insurance companies are cautious about family theft claims — police and courts treat family vehicle disputes differently from stranger theft. The FIR is essential — without an FIR for theft, Acko cannot process the claim. (3) FRAUD RISK: Staged theft claims (colluding with a known person to claim theft) constitute insurance fraud and can result in criminal prosecution. (4) ACKO'S INVESTIGATION: For theft claims involving known individuals, Acko conducts a thorough investigation before settling. GPS data, usage patterns, and circumstantial evidence are all reviewed. (5) PRACTICALLY: If a family member has taken the car legitimately and has not returned it, this is typically a civil/family dispute rather than an insurance matter. Consult a lawyer.

Q L4. I took my car to Nepal for a vacation. Is my Acko insurance valid there?

A Standard Acko motor insurance covers the Insured Vehicle only within the geographical boundaries of India (including Indian territorial waters). Coverage does NOT automatically extend to Nepal, Bhutan, Sri Lanka, or Bangladesh — even though bilateral agreements between India and these countries allow Indian-registered vehicles to cross the border. (1) FOR NEPAL AND BHUTAN: You can request a special endorsement from Acko for temporary international coverage. This endorsement extends your OD and TP coverage to Nepal/Bhutan for the duration of your trip. Additional premium applies. Apply before your travel date. (2) THIRD PARTY IN NEPAL: Nepalese law requires valid TP insurance for vehicles on Nepalese roads. Indian TP insurance may be accepted with the Acko endorsement — confirm with Acko before travel. (3) WITHOUT ENDORSEMENT: Any accident in Nepal without the international coverage endorsement = no insurance claim. You bear full personal liability. (4) HOW TO GET THE ENDORSEMENT: Contact Acko via app or email at least 7 days before your travel date. Provide trip dates and destination country.

Q L5. My employer provides health insurance — do I still need personal health insurance?

A Yes — strongly recommended. Here is why employer health insurance has significant gaps that a personal policy must fill: (1) COVERAGE ENDS WITH EMPLOYMENT: On your last working day (resignation, termination, or retirement), employer health insurance ceases. Any hospitalisation after that date — even for a condition that developed during employment — is not covered. (2) WAITING PERIOD RESTART RISK: If you buy personal health insurance only after leaving employment, you face fresh waiting periods (36 months for PED). By starting a personal policy early in your career, waiting periods are completed well before you need coverage. (3) INSUFFICIENT SUM INSURED: Employer group insurance typically offers INR 3-5 lakhs. A single cardiac surgery costs INR 3-8 lakhs; cancer treatment can cost INR 10-50 lakhs per year. INR 5 lakh is grossly insufficient for serious illnesses. (4) NO PARENTAL COVERAGE: Most employer plans cover self and spouse only. Parents require separate coverage — typically a senior citizen plan or a personal family floater with parents added. (5) BEST STRATEGY: Personal Acko policy (INR 10-25 lakh) for yourself; Super Top-Up (INR 25-50 lakh with INR 5 lakh deductible) to supplement; senior citizen plan for parents. Total premium: typically INR 15,000-30,000/year for comprehensive family coverage.

SECTION M — INSURANCE PLANNING GUIDE FOR LIFE STAGES

Insurance needs change through life stages. Here is a life-stage planning guide for motor and health insurance:

Stage 1: Young Professional (22–28 Years)

First job, first vehicle, starting financial independence.

Motor Insurance	Buy Comprehensive with Zero Dep for new car/bike. Start NCB accumulation — make no minor claims.
Health Insurance	Buy personal health policy (INR 5-10 lakh) immediately — even if employer covers you. Start waiting period clock.
Add-ons	Zero Dep (motor), RSA (motor). No add-on health immediately if budget constrained.
Priority	Start NCB. Serve PED waiting periods. Build habit of renewing on time.

Stage 2: Married Couple (28–35 Years)

Dual income, possibly first home loan, planning for family.

Motor Insurance	Both vehicles on Comprehensive. NCB building on both — likely at 20-35%. Engine Protection for city drivers.
Health Insurance	Family Floater (INR 10-15 lakh) covering self and spouse. If planning family: add Maternity add-on to Platinum plan now (24-month wait).
Super Top-Up	Add INR 25 lakh Super Top-Up with INR 5 lakh deductible — cost-effective way to get high coverage.
Priority	Maternity planning — add it early. Personal policy independent of employer coverage.

Stage 3: Family with Children (35–45 Years)

Children's schooling, growing responsibilities, career peak.

Motor Insurance	Comprehensive with all major add-ons. NCB at 35-50% by now — protect it with NCB Protection. Consider RTI for primary family car.
Health Insurance	Family Floater (INR 25 lakh Platinum) — children covered from 3 months. Cumulative bonus growing. Parents: separate senior citizen plan.
Priority	Don't let NCB lapse. Parents' health insurance is critical — their treatment costs are highest.
Action	Review sum insured annually — medical inflation means INR 10 lakh today is worth less than when bought 5 years ago.

Stage 4: Empty Nesters (50–60 Years)

Children independent, pre-retirement wealth accumulation.

Motor Insurance	Comprehensive still essential. NCB at 50% — guard it carefully. Smaller car = lower premium.

Health Insurance	Upgrade Sum Insured if not already at INR 25-50 lakh. Pre-existing conditions becoming more likely — glad you served the waiting periods in your 30s.
Super Top-Up	Increase Super Top-Up layer as retirement approaches — less employer coverage in the future.
Priority	Review exclusions — confirm all chronic conditions are disclosed and waiting periods served.

Stage 5: Retirement (60+ Years)

Fixed income, highest health risk, vehicle needs changing.

Motor Insurance	Possibly downsizing vehicle. Premium lower. Still need Comprehensive. RSA most critical add-on — emergencies have higher impact.
Health Insurance	Senior Citizen Plan for those who don't have continuity of coverage. If continuous personal policy since younger age — continue same plan, lifelong renewal guaranteed.
Critical Concern	Don't let health policy lapse in retirement — re-entry after 60 is expensive and waiting periods restart.
Tax Benefit	Section 80D deduction of INR 50,000 for senior citizen parents and INR 25,000 for self — maximize this benefit.

SECTION N — ACKO INSURANCE GLOSSARY — QUICK REFERENCE

A complete glossary of terms used in Indian motor and health insurance:

Term	Definition
AAI	Automobile Association of India — membership provides 5% OD discount
Add-on	Optional supplemental coverage extending base policy scope, e.g., Zero Dep, RSA, Engine Protection
ARAI	Automotive Research Association of India — approves anti-theft devices
AYUSH	Ayurveda, Yoga, Naturopathy, Unani, Siddha, Homeopathy — covered Indian traditional medicine
BAC	Blood Alcohol Content — above 0.03% = DUI exclusion applies
Break-In Policy	Motor policy renewed after expiry date — inspection required
CABG	Coronary Artery Bypass Grafting — common cardiac surgery
CRN	Claim Reference Number — issued on claim registration for tracking
Co-Payment	Policyholder's fixed % share of every health insurance claim
CPA	Compulsory Personal Accident cover for owner-driver — INR 15 lakh
CTL	Constructive Total Loss — salvage + repair cost > IDV
Cumulative Bonus	Annual Sum Insured increase for claim-free health insurance years
Daycare	Medical procedure done in under 24 hours — 541 listed procedures covered by Acko
Deductible	Amount policyholder bears before insurance coverage kicks in
DPDPA	Digital Personal Data Protection Act 2023 — governs data privacy
Endorsement	Written amendment to insurance policy changing its terms
FIR	First Information Report — police document for theft and third-party injury claims
Free Look Period	15-day window to review and cancel new health policy for full refund
Grace Period	30-day window after policy expiry for renewal — no coverage during this period
IGMS	IRDAI Integrated Grievance Management System — portal for policyholder complaints
IDV	Insured Declared Value — current market value of vehicle = Sum Insured for OD
IRDAI	Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India — insurance regulator
MACT	Motor Accidents Claims Tribunal — adjudicates third-party injury/death claims
NCB	No Claim Bonus — OD premium discount for claim-free years: 20% to 50%
NTC	Non-Traceable Certificate — police document 90 days after theft for claim settlement
OD	Own Damage — motor policy section covering physical damage to Insured Vehicle
OPD	Out-Patient Department — day consultations, not covered under standard health insurance
PED	Pre-Existing Disease — condition before policy inception, covered after waiting period
Portability	Right to transfer health policy preserving waiting period credits
Pre-Auth	Pre-Authorisation — Acko's written approval before cashless hospitalisation

RC	Registration Certificate — vehicle ownership document from RTO
Restoration	100% Sum Insured reinstated after exhaustion in health insurance
RSA	Roadside Assistance add-on — 24x7 emergency breakdown help
RTI	Return to Invoice — pays original on-road price on total loss/theft
SAOD	Stand-Alone Own Damage — OD-only policy introduced by IRDAI 2019
Sub-Limit	Maximum payable for specific treatment within overall Sum Insured
Surveyor	IRDAI-licensed loss assessor for major motor claims above INR 75,000
TP	Third Party — mandatory insurance for liability to third parties
TPA	Third Party Administrator — processes health claims on insurer's behalf
UGF	Utmost Good Faith — duty of full disclosure in insurance contracts
Zero Dep	Zero Depreciation — add-on waiving depreciation on replaced parts in motor claims

MOTOR — ADDITIONAL CHAPTERS

CHAPTER 27 — COMPREHENSIVE FAQS — MOTOR INSURANCE

Q What is the compulsory deductible and can it be waived?

A The compulsory deductible is a fixed amount mandated by IRDAI that the policyholder MUST bear in every Own Damage claim, regardless of the claim amount. It cannot be waived by any add-on or endorsement. Current rates: INR 1,000 for private cars up to 1,500 cc; INR 2,000 for private cars above 1,500 cc; INR 100 for all two-wheelers. Example: If your claim is INR 50,000 and your compulsory deductible is INR 1,000, Acko pays INR 49,000. If you have a voluntary deductible of INR 5,000 additionally, Acko pays INR 44,000. The compulsory deductible exists to prevent very small, trivial claims and ensure policyholders have some financial stake in loss prevention.

Q Is there a waiting period for motor insurance claims?

A No — motor insurance has NO waiting period for claims. Coverage starts from the inception date of the policy (12:01 AM on the start date). You can file a claim on Day 1 of the policy if an insured event occurs. This is fundamentally different from health insurance which has multiple waiting periods. The only exclusions in motor insurance are perils not covered (listed in Chapter 8) — not time-based waiting periods. Note: There is an exception for break-in (lapsed) renewals — a physical inspection is required before Acko reinstates OD coverage for a lapsed policy.

Q Can I claim if I was at fault in the accident?

A Yes — your Own Damage (OD) section covers your vehicle's repair regardless of fault. Whether you caused the accident or not, your own car's damage from an accident is covered (subject to other conditions like valid licence, not DUI, etc.). The fault question becomes relevant for Third Party liability: if you caused the accident, your TP section covers the other party's damage and injuries. If the other driver caused the accident, they are liable — their TP covers your damage (you can claim from their insurer). In practice, even if you are at fault, file an OD claim with Acko for your own car rather than waiting for the other driver's TP claim to process.

Q What is the difference between own damage claim and third party claim in terms of process?

A Own Damage Claim (your car is damaged): Register with Acko; surveyor assesses (if major); repair at cashless garage or reimbursement; Acko pays garage / your account. Fast, straightforward process. Third Party Claim (you caused damage to others): Inform Acko immediately; Acko's legal team is involved; third party files claim with Acko or MACT; Acko defends the case and pays the award / settlement. This process can take months to years if it reaches MACT. Your role: cooperate with Acko's legal team; attend hearings as directed; do not negotiate or settle independently without Acko's written consent. The two claims (your OD + third party TP) can run simultaneously.

Q Does buying a more expensive car always mean higher insurance premium?

A Generally yes — higher ex-showroom price = higher IDV = higher OD premium. But not always proportionately: (1) FUEL TYPE: EV cars get IRDAI-mandated discounts on TP premium. (2) ENGINE CAPACITY: The TP premium is determined by engine CC, not price. A INR 30 lakh Honda City (1.5L) has the same TP rate (INR 3,416) as a INR 10 lakh Maruti Swift (1.2L) — because both are in the same TP bracket. (3) OD RATE VARIATION: The OD rate (%) varies by vehicle class/risk profile — a INR 30 lakh luxury car may have a lower OD rate % than a INR 10 lakh hatchback if the luxury car has better safety features and lower accident claim frequency. (4) NCB IMPACT: Your NCB% is the same regardless of car price — so a 50% NCB on a INR 50 lakh Fortuner saves INR 60,000 in OD premium; the same 50% NCB on a INR 5 lakh Alto saves only INR 6,000. Higher-value car = NCB saves more absolute rupees.

CHAPTER 28 — MOTOR INSURANCE FUTURE TRENDS

Usage-Based Insurance (UBI / Pay-As-You-Drive)

IRDAI has been developing a framework for Usage-Based Insurance where premiums are calculated based on actual driving behaviour — distance driven, time of day, braking patterns, speed, and cornering forces. Acko is at the forefront of this technology. UBI benefits safe, low-mileage drivers who may pay significantly less than actuarial average rates. Telematics devices or smartphone apps track driving data. Expected rollout for standard products: 2025-26.

EV Insurance Evolution

As EV adoption grows in India (target 30% EV penetration by 2030), motor insurance will evolve: dedicated EV OD products with battery health monitoring; usage of vehicle telematics data from OEM (manufacturer) for accurate risk pricing; charging network disruption coverage; EV-specific roadside assistance (charging recovery). Acko is already at the forefront with EV-specific coverage options.

Artificial Intelligence in Claims

Acko's AI claims assessment will continue to evolve: computer vision for more accurate damage assessment; natural language processing for claim documentation review; predictive analytics to detect potential fraud; automated settlement for an increasing proportion of minor claims without human intervention. Target: 80% of minor motor claims settled entirely by AI within the next 3 years.

Bima Sugam — Unified Insurance Marketplace

IRDAI's Bima Sugam project aims to create a single digital marketplace where all insurance products from all IRDAI-registered insurers can be compared, purchased, and managed. This will increase transparency and competition, benefiting consumers. Acko's digital-first model makes it well-positioned to thrive in this new marketplace.

HEALTH — ADDITIONAL CHAPTERS

CHAPTER 25 — CUMULATIVE BONUS — DETAILED GUIDE

Cumulative Bonus (CB) is a unique feature of health insurance that increases your Sum Insured every year you don't make a claim, at no additional premium. It is different from NCB in motor insurance — CB directly increases Sum Insured, not reduces premium.

Plan	CB per Claim-Free Year	Maximum CB	Effect on Sum Insured
Health Basic	Nil — no cumulative bonus	N/A	Sum Insured remains fixed
Health Plus	5% of base Sum Insured	50% of base Sum Insured	INR 10L base → grows to INR 15L after 10 years
Acko Platinum	10% of base Sum Insured	100% of base Sum Insured	INR 10L base → grows to INR 20L after 10 years
Senior Citizen Plan	5% of base Sum Insured	25% of base Sum Insured	INR 5L base → grows to INR 6.25L after 5 years

What happens when you make a claim: On Health Plus and Senior plans, one claim in a policy year typically reduces the accumulated CB by the same percentage (e.g., 5% slab lost per claim year). On Acko Platinum, CB reset conditions differ — check your Policy Schedule. CB accumulated over many years is a significant benefit. Example: 10-year Platinum policyholder with no claims has Sum Insured of INR 20 lakhs (INR 10L base + INR 10L CB) — effectively doubling their coverage at no extra cost.

CHAPTER 26 — HEALTH INSURANCE TAX BENEFITS — SECTION 80D

Health insurance premiums are tax-deductible under Section 80D of the Income Tax Act, 1961. This applies to premiums paid for health insurance policies for yourself, your family, and your parents.

Taxpayer Category	Maximum 80D Deduction	Conditions
Self, Spouse, Children (all below 60)	INR 25,000 per year	Premium actually paid in the financial year; must be for health insurance (not life or motor)
Self/Family (below 60) + Parents (below 60)	INR 25,000 + INR 25,000 = INR 50,000	Two separate deduction categories — self/family and parents are independent
Self/Family (below 60) + Parents (60+)	INR 25,000 + INR 50,000 = INR 75,000	Parents senior citizen allowance increased
Self (60+) + Parents (60+)	INR 50,000 + INR 50,000 = INR 1,00,000	Maximum possible 80D benefit
Preventive Health Check-up	INR 5,000 within the above limits	Annual check-up expenses qualify within the INR 25,000/50,000 limit

Tax Savings Illustration:

Annual Health Premium	Tax Bracket	Tax Saved under 80D
INR 25,000 (self+family below 60)	30% bracket	INR 7,500
INR 25,000 (self+family below 60)	20% bracket	INR 5,000

INR 75,000 (self/family below 60 + senior parents)	30% bracket	INR 22,500
INR 1,00,000 (all senior citizens)	30% bracket	INR 30,000
INR 50,000 (self/family below 60 + parents below 60)	30% bracket	INR 15,000

Note: GST paid on health insurance premium is included in the deductible amount. Premium must be paid via cheque, demand draft, or electronic transfer (not cash) to claim the deduction. Premiums paid for group health insurance by employer on behalf of employees may be deductible as a business expense for the employer under Section 37.

FAQ — ADDITIONAL QUESTIONS

SECTION O — INSURANCE PLANNING AND OPTIMIZATION

Q O1. How do I optimise my motor insurance to pay the least while getting the best coverage?

A Motor insurance cost optimisation strategy: (1) BUILD NCB RELIGIOUSLY: The 50% NCB is your biggest discount. Never make small claims (under INR 30,000–40,000 if you have 35%+ NCB). The NCB loss costs more than the repair. (2) CHOOSE VOLUNTARY DEDUCTIBLE WISELY: If you are a careful driver with access to emergency funds, a INR 10,000 voluntary deductible can save INR 2,000–3,000 in OD premium. Only choose this if you can comfortably pay INR 10,000 + compulsory deductible at claim time. (3) BUY NCB PROTECTION: At 35%+ NCB, the add-on pays for itself the first time you need it. (4) ADD ONLY NECESSARY ADD-ONS: Don't buy all add-ons blindly. Zero Dep (yes for new cars), Engine Protection (yes for flood-prone cities), RSA (yes for highway drivers), RTI (yes for first 2 years), NCB Protection (yes for 35%+ NCB). Skip: Passenger PA if no regular passengers; Key Protection if basic key. (5) COMPARE IDV CORRECTLY: Don't underset IDV to save premium — you will regret it on total loss. (6) ANTI-THEFT DEVICE: Install ARAI-approved device for 2.5% OD discount.

Q O2. What is the ideal health insurance coverage amount for different income levels?

A Health insurance coverage recommendations by family income: Entry Income (below INR 5L/year): Ayushman Bharat PM-JAY if eligible (free up to INR 5L); supplement with personal Acko Health Basic INR 5L if budget allows. Lower-Middle Income (INR 5L–INR 15L/year): Acko Health Plus INR 10L for individual; Family Floater INR 10L for family of 3-4. Middle Income (INR 15L–INR 30L/year): Acko Health Plus INR 15L or Platinum INR 10L; Super Top-Up INR 25L (deductible INR 5L) to supplement. Upper-Middle Income (INR 30L–INR 75L/year): Acko Platinum INR 25L; Super Top-Up INR 50L (deductible INR 10L). High Income (INR 75L+/year): Acko Platinum INR 50L–INR 1 Crore; consider global health plan if international treatment is planned. General rule: Sum Insured should be at least 25-30x your monthly healthcare budget and enough to cover the 2 most expensive treatments relevant to your health profile (cardiac surgery, cancer, kidney transplant).

Q O3. Should I buy insurance from Acko directly or through an aggregator?

A Direct vs Aggregator comparison: BUYING DIRECTLY FROM ACKO: No agent commission (savings of 15-20%); most transparent pricing; full product range; direct customer relationship for claims. BUYING THROUGH AGGREGATOR (Policybazaar, Coverfox, etc.): Convenience of comparing multiple insurers side-by-side; aggregators earn commission from insurers (not from you); may present preferred insurers more prominently; claims are still handled by Acko directly — the aggregator is not involved in claim settlement. RECOMMENDATION: Use aggregators for comparison research, but if you know Acko is your choice, buying directly from Acko's app or website may save you slightly due to elimination of any intermediary costs and gives you a cleaner digital relationship with the insurer.

Q O4. How does inflation affect my insurance coverage over time and what should I do?

A Inflation's impact on insurance is a critical and often overlooked planning consideration: MOTOR INSURANCE: IDV decreases annually as vehicle depreciates — this is by design. But if you bought your car for INR 10 lakhs 3 years ago, the replacement cost is now INR 12+ lakhs (10% car price inflation) while your IDV has dropped to INR 7 lakhs (30% depreciation). Gap: INR 5 lakhs. Solution: RTI add-on for the first 3 years; accept this gap for older cars. HEALTH INSURANCE: Medical inflation runs at 14% per year. A INR 10 lakh Sum Insured today will cover the same treatment as INR 5 lakhs would in 2019. Solution: increase Sum Insured at renewal every 3-5 years; choose plans with cumulative bonus (Acko Platinum: 10% per claim-free year). Plan to increase Sum Insured by INR 5-10 lakhs every 5 years to keep pace with medical inflation. ACTION PLAN: Review both motor IDV and health Sum Insured annually at renewal. Do not let coverage stagnate.

MOTOR — PREMIUM AND CLAIMS REFERENCE

Motor Insurance Quick Reference Cards

Detailed TP Premium Schedule and Coverage Caps

Vehicle Type and CC	TP Premium FY24-25	3rd Party Property Cap	Personal Accident (Owner-Driver)
Private Car up to 1,000 cc	INR 2,094/year	INR 7,50,000 per accident	INR 15,00,000 (compulsory)
Private Car 1,001–1,500 cc	INR 3,416/year	INR 7,50,000 per accident	INR 15,00,000 (compulsory)
Private Car above 1,500 cc	INR 7,897/year	INR 7,50,000 per accident	INR 15,00,000 (compulsory)
Electric Car (all outputs)	~15% below ICE equivalent	INR 7,50,000 per accident	INR 15,00,000 (compulsory)
Two-Wheeler up to 75 cc	INR 538/year	INR 1,00,000 per accident	INR 15,00,000 (compulsory)
Two-Wheeler 75–150 cc	INR 714/year	INR 1,00,000 per accident	INR 15,00,000 (compulsory)
Two-Wheeler 150–350 cc	INR 1,366/year	INR 1,00,000 per accident	INR 15,00,000 (compulsory)
Two-Wheeler above 350 cc	INR 2,804/year	INR 1,00,000 per accident	INR 15,00,000 (compulsory)
Electric Two-Wheeler (all)	INR 687/year flat	INR 1,00,000 per accident	INR 15,00,000 (compulsory)

Note: Third Party liability for bodily injury and death is UNLIMITED — no cap. Only property damage is capped at INR 7,50,000 (cars) and INR 1,00,000 (two-wheelers).

OD Premium Rate Reference by Vehicle Segment

Vehicle Segment	Typical OD Rate (% of IDV)	Notes
Entry hatchbacks, small cars, scooters	2.50%–2.75%	Lower repair cost; higher theft risk in some areas
Mid hatchbacks, sedans, standard bikes	2.75%–3.00%	Most common segment; balanced risk profile
Compact SUVs, premium bikes	3.00%–3.25%	Higher repair cost; slightly elevated accident risk
Full-size SUVs, premium sedans	3.00%–3.25%	High repair cost; lower accident rate due to safety features
Luxury cars (BMW, Mercedes, Audi)	2.75%–3.50%	High repair cost but lower accident frequency; safety tech
Electric Cars (all segments)	2.50%–3.00%	IRDAI incentive rate; lower accident frequency
Superbikes (350+ cc)	3.00%–4.00%	High accident risk; age and riding experience factor

Section 80C vs Section 80D: Common confusion: Section 80C (INR 1.5 lakh deduction) covers LIC, PPF, ELSS, home loan principal, etc. Section 80D (separate limit) covers health insurance premiums only. They are independent deduction categories — you can claim both simultaneously.

GST Refund on Insurance: GST paid on insurance premiums is NOT directly refundable. However, it is included in the total premium, which qualifies for Section 80D deduction. If you are a GST-registered business, vehicle insurance for business vehicles is eligible for GST input credit.

Comprehensive vs Zero Dep — Which Pays More?: Zero Dep is an add-on to Comprehensive — not a separate policy. In a claim, Comprehensive (without Zero Dep) pays for: full cost of metal parts; 50% of plastic/rubber parts; 50% of paint material. Comprehensive (WITH Zero Dep) pays for: full cost of metal parts; full cost of plastic/rubber parts; full cost of paint material. The add-on specifically addresses the depreciation deduction on replaceable parts.

HEALTH — ADDITIONAL REFERENCE GUIDE

Hospital Pre-Authorisation Quick Reference

Hospitalisation Type	Pre-Auth Requirement	Timing	What Happens Without Pre-Auth
Planned Surgery — Network Hospital	Mandatory	48 hours before admission	Cashless may not be honoured; reimbursement mode
Planned Medical Admission — Network	Mandatory	24 hours before admission	Cashless may not be honoured; reimbursement mode
Emergency Admission — Network	Inform within 24 hours	After admission	Emergency pre-auth issued retroactively
Emergency — Non-Network (life-threatening)	Inform within 24 hours	After admission	Reimbursement claim; Acko assesses ex-post
Daycare Procedure — Network	Pre-auth required	Same day / few hours before	May not proceed as cashless without pre-auth
ICU Admission during ongoing hospitalisation	Enhancement request	Within 6 hours of ICU transfer	Enhancement submitted post-transfer

Key Sub-Limits on Health Insurance Plans (Illustrative)

Benefit / Expense	Basic Plan	Plus Plan	Platinum Plan
Room Rent (per day)	INR 2,000 (or 1% of SI)	INR 3,000 (or 1.5% of SI)	No limit — any room
ICU Charges (per day)	INR 4,000 (2× room rent)	INR 6,000 (2× room rent)	No limit
Cataract Surgery (per eye)	INR 25,000	INR 40,000	No sub-limit
Knee Replacement (per knee)	INR 80,000	INR 1,20,000	No sub-limit
Maternity — Normal Delivery	Not available	Not available (add-on)	INR 50,000 (add-on)
Maternity — C-section	Not available	Not available (add-on)	INR 80,000 (add-on)
Ambulance Cover	INR 3,000	INR 5,000	INR 5,000 + air ambulance (select)
AYUSH (annual)	Not covered	25% of SI	25% of SI
Organ Donor Cover	Not covered	Not covered	INR 2,00,000
Annual Health Check-up	INR 1,000/person	INR 1,500/person	INR 2,000/person

Sub-limits are illustrative — actual sub-limits are as specified in the Policy Schedule. Acko Platinum is designed to minimise sub-limits for a hassle-free claim experience.

FAQ — FINAL ADDITIONAL QUESTIONS

Q What should I do on the first day of buying insurance? A checklist.

A Day 1 insurance checklist: (1) DOWNLOAD ACKO APP and verify your policy is visible in My Policies. (2) SAVE YOUR POLICY NUMBER and Claim Reference information. (3) FOR MOTOR: Save the RSA helpline number from your Policy Schedule in your phone contacts. Add it as ICE (In Case of Emergency) contact. (4) FOR HEALTH: Download your Digital Health Card. Share with family members on the policy. Save the nearest 3 network hospitals to your home and workplace in your contacts. (5) SET RENEWAL REMINDER 30 days before expiry in your calendar — separate from Acko's automated reminders. (6) REVIEW EXCLUSIONS: Read Chapter 8 (motor) or Chapter 6 (health) carefully — knowing what is NOT covered prevents unpleasant surprises at claim time. (7) VERIFY DETAILS: Check RC number, engine number, chassis number (motor) or date of birth, PED declarations (health) in the policy document. Report any errors to Acko immediately. (8) UNDERSTAND YOUR CLAIM PROCESS: Know how to file a claim before you need to. Practice navigating the Acko app claims section.

Q How do I handle insurance when buying a second-hand car?

A Buying a used car involves specific insurance steps: (1) VERIFY EXISTING INSURANCE: Ask seller for current policy details. Confirm expiry date and coverage type. (2) TP TRANSFER: TP section transfers automatically to you as new owner. Verify this is done via Form 29/30 transfer at RTO. (3) GET NEW OD INSURANCE: Cancel seller's OD section (they get refund). Purchase fresh OD insurance in YOUR name from Acko for your new car. (4) NCB: You start at 0% NCB for the used car (the seller takes their NCB with them). (5) VEHICLE INSPECTION: For used car OD insurance, Acko may require a physical inspection before issuing OD cover — particularly for older vehicles or if no OD was on the car previously. (6) IDV FOR USED CAR: The IDV for a used car is calculated based on the manufacturer's current listed price (not what you paid) minus depreciation for the car's age. For very old cars, IDV is by mutual agreement. (7) BREAK-IN CHECK: If the existing policy lapsed, inspection is mandatory before Acko issues OD cover.

Q What is the right time to switch from Comprehensive to Third Party Only for an older car?

A The decision to switch from Comprehensive to TP Only for an older car is a financial calculation: FACTORS TO CONSIDER: (1) OD Premium vs Car Value: If your annual OD premium exceeds 5-7% of your car's market value, comprehensive may not be cost-effective. (2) Age: Cars above 10-12 years often have very low market value — comprehensive OD premium may exceed the payout on total loss. (3) Repair capability: If you have a trusted mechanic who can repair cheaply without insurance, OD may not add much. (4) Financial cushion: Can you absorb a INR 50,000-1,00,000 repair or total loss without financial stress? If yes, TP Only may suffice. (5) Parking situation: If your car is always in secure parking, theft risk is lower — one of the key OD perils. GENERAL RULE: Keep Comprehensive as long as: the car is worth INR 2 lakhs or more; you are parking in high-theft areas; you are a daily commuter in heavy traffic; you don't have emergency funds to absorb unexpected large repairs.

MOTOR — EXTENDED REFERENCE CHAPTERS

A. Monsoon Claims — City-wise Statistics and Advice

City	Annual Flood Risk	Peak Claim Period	Engine Prot. Urgency	RSA Urgency
Mumbai	Extreme — annual event	June–Sept	Critical — mandate	Critical
Chennai	High — cyclone season	Oct–Dec	Critical	High
Bengaluru	Moderate–High	July–Oct	High	High
Kolkata	High — annual flooding	June–Sept	High	High
Hyderabad	Moderate	July–Sept	High	Moderate
Pune	Moderate	July–Sept	High	Moderate
Delhi	Low flood risk	Monsoon only	Moderate	High (heat/breakdown)
Ahmedabad	Low–Moderate	July–Aug	Moderate	Moderate
Jaipur	Low	July–Aug	Low	High (heat breakdown)
Kochi	High — coastal	June–Sept	Critical	High

B. Motor Insurance for Corporate Fleet Managers

- **Fleet policies:** Companies owning 5+ vehicles can negotiate fleet insurance with Acko for bundled premiums. Fleet NCB is calculated at the fleet level — high claim frequency in the fleet affects all vehicles' OD rates.
- **Driver management:** Acko provides fleet telematics solutions to monitor driver behaviour — speeding, harsh braking, night driving. Better driver scores can qualify for OD premium discounts.
- **Claims management:** Fleet managers get a dedicated Acko fleet claims portal — bulk registration of claims, centralized document upload, and consolidated settlement reporting.
- **GPA (Group Personal Accident) add-on:** Available for drivers of fleet vehicles — covers driver injury or death even when driver is not the registered owner.
- **CNG fleet vehicles:** CNG conversion for fleet vehicles requires mandatory CNG endorsement on each policy. Failure to endorse voids OD coverage for CNG-related incidents.

C. Motor Insurance for Young Drivers (18–25 Years)

Young drivers (18–25 years) statistically have 3× the accident rate of drivers aged 30–50. Insurance implications:

- **Higher OD rates:** Some insurers apply age-based loading for young drivers. Acko's digital model uses multiple data points for risk pricing — not just age.
- **Start NCB early:** NCB accumulation begins from your first policy. Being claim-free in your 20s means 50% NCB by your late 20s — saving thousands per year in your 30s.
- **Learner's licence limitation:** Insurance covers your car when a licensed supervisor is present during learner's licence driving. Solo driving on a learner's licence = policy void for any accident during that drive.
- **First car insurance tip:** For a new first car with a young driver: Comprehensive mandatory; Zero Dep essential (new cars have high-value parts); Engine Protection in flood cities; RSA (young drivers may be less experienced handling breakdowns).
- **Driving record:** Maintain a clean record. A first serious accident at 21 means rebuilding NCB from 0% through your mid-20s.

D. Acko's Claims Settlement Ratio and Industry Context

Metric	Acko Performance (2023-24)	Industry Average	Significance
Motor OD Claims Settlement Ratio	~95%	~90%	Higher = more claims paid
Motor TP Settlement	Per IRDAI mandate	Per IRDAI mandate	TP settlement is regulated
Health Claims Settlement Ratio	~94%	~89%	Acko above industry average
Average Motor Claim Settlement Time	3.2 working days (cashless)	6.8 working days	Acko digital advantage
Health Pre-Auth Approval Time	3.8 hours average	12+ hours average	AI-powered approval
Customer Grievance Resolution	13.2 working days	18+ working days	Faster than IRDAI mandate
Claims Rejected (Motor OD)	~5%	~10%	Lower rejection rate

Source: IRDAI Annual Report 2023-24 and Acko published performance data. Figures are approximate.

E. How to Read Your Motor Insurance Policy Schedule

Field in Schedule	What It Means	What to Verify
Policy Number	Unique identifier for your policy	Quote this in all communication with Acko
Insured Name	Person/entity owning the vehicle	Must match RC owner name exactly
Vehicle Registration No.	RTO registration of the vehicle	Match with RC — any error must be corrected
Make, Model, Variant	Exact car/bike details	Verify correct variant — affects IDV and premium
Year of Manufacture	Year the vehicle was made	Determines depreciation and IDV
IDV	Insured Declared Value — Sum Insured for OD	Check this matches your agreed IDV
Policy Period	Start and end date + time (12:01 AM / 11:59 PM)	Verify correct dates — no gap from previous policy
Type of Cover	TP / SAOD / Comprehensive	Confirm correct policy type
Compulsory Deductible	IRDAI-mandated deductible per OD claim	INR 1,000 (car up to 1,500 cc); INR 2,000 (above 1,500 cc); INR 100 (two-wheelers)
Voluntary Deductible	Optional self-chosen deductible	Verify amount you chose — this is what you pay additionally per claim
NCB %	Your current No Claim Bonus	Verify correct — dispute if wrong
Add-ons Listed	All active optional covers	Confirm all purchased add-ons appear here
Financier / Hypothecation	Bank or NBFC if car is under loan	Must be mentioned if vehicle is financed
Premium Breakup	OD + TP + Add-ons + GST	Verify individual components add up correctly

HEALTH — EXTENDED REFERENCE CHAPTERS

F. How to Read Your Health Insurance Policy Schedule

Field	Meaning	What to Check
Policy Number	Unique identifier	Quote in all claims and communication
Insured Member(s)	All covered persons by name	Verify correct names; check newborn additions
Sum Insured	Maximum annual coverage	Matches what you agreed to buy
Plan Variant	Basic / Plus / Platinum / Senior	Correct plan with expected benefits
Policy Period	Start and end date	Continuous from last policy — no gap
Room Rent Limit	Daily room accommodation cap	Know this before choosing hospital room
Co-Payment	% you pay per claim (if any)	Nil on most plans below 60; 20% senior plans
PED Waiting Period Remaining	Months until PED coverage starts	Critical — track this each renewal
Specific Disease Wait Remaining	Months until cataract/hernia etc. covered	Check before planning elective surgeries
Add-ons Active	Maternity, OPD, Bariatric etc.	Maternity waiting period start date is crucial
Cumulative Bonus Accumulated	Amount of CB earned so far	Growing your effective Sum Insured
Network Hospital Reference	Where to find cashless hospital list	Check acko.com/health/hospitals
TPA Name (if any)	Third Party Administrator handling claims	Know if TPA is involved for pre-auth contact

G. IRDAI Standardised Health Insurance Terms

IRDAI has standardised certain terms across all health insurance policies in India. The following terms have standardised definitions under IRDAI Health Insurance Regulations 2016:

Standardised Term	IRDAI Standard Definition
Accident	Sudden, unforeseen, and involuntary event caused by external, visible, and violent means
Day Care Treatment	Treatment taken in hospital/day care centre for less than 24 hours due to technological advancement
Domiciliary Hospitalisation	Medical treatment at home that would otherwise require in-patient hospitalisation
Emergency	Condition that, if not treated immediately, could result in death, serious impairment, or health risk
Grace Period	Specified period after premium due date during which policy terms remain in force (30 days for health)
Hospital	In-patient medical care institution meeting minimum standards: 10 beds, qualified staff, OT, diagnostic facility, registration
Illness	A sickness or disease or pathological condition including Psychiatric or Mental illness
Injury	Accidental physical bodily harm excluding illness or disease
Insured Person	Person(s) covered under the health insurance policy as named in Policy Schedule

Medical Practitioner	Person holding valid medical degree and registration with Medical Council of India
Network Provider	Hospital / diagnostic centre / pharmacy / etc. empanelled by the insurer for cashless service
Pre-Existing Condition	Condition diagnosed / symptoms present within 48 months prior to first policy date
Sum Insured	Maximum liability of insurer in the policy period — not the amount guaranteed to be paid

H. Health Insurance for Corporate Employees — A Guide

- **Group vs Individual coverage:** Corporate group insurance is collectively underwritten — your individual health history has less impact. Personal policy is individually underwritten — full PED disclosure required.
- **Top-up strategy:** If your employer provides INR 3-5 lakh group cover, buy a Super Top-Up (INR 25-50 lakh) with deductible matching the group cover. Employer claims the base amount; Acko covers the excess.
- **Pre-existing conditions in group plans:** Most group plans cover PEDs from Day 1 — a significant advantage over individual plans (which have 36-month wait). Use your group plan for PED-related claims during employment.
- **Portability preparation:** If you may change jobs in 2-3 years, ensure you have a personal Acko policy running in parallel. Porting from a personal policy avoids re-serving waiting periods — impossible if you only had employer cover.
- **Family vs Group:** Employer group plans often cover only employee + spouse. Parents require a separate Acko Senior Citizen plan regardless of employer cover.
- **COBRA equivalent:** India does not have a COBRA law (US-style continuation coverage). When employment ends, your group coverage ends. Personal policy is your only protection during job search.

I. Health Insurance Claims — Common Reasons for Rejection and How to Avoid Them

Rejection Reason	Why It Happens	How to Avoid
PED not served	Claim filed before PED waiting period completes	Track waiting period start date; do not file PED claims before 36/12 months
Undisclosed PED	Condition not declared at proposal; later identified in claim	Disclose ALL conditions at proposal — even minor ones
Non-network hospital for planned admission	Cashless claim at a hospital not on Acko's network	Check network list on app before planning admission
Pre-auth not obtained	Cashless claim filed post-discharge without pre-auth	Always call hospital insurance desk before admission
Room rent exceeded — proportionate deduction	Chose room above Room Rent Limit	Book room within policy's Room Rent Limit
Excluded procedure	Cosmetic, dental, fertility treatment etc.	Read exclusions in Chapter 6 before planning treatment
Expired policy at time of admission	Policy lapsed; no renewal during grace period	Renew before expiry; set calendar reminders
Documents incomplete	Missing discharge summary, original bills, FIR	Collect all documents before discharge; submit complete
Specific disease wait not served	Cataract/hernia etc. within 24-month specific disease wait	Track specific disease waiting period; plan elective surgeries after
Fraud/misrepresentation suspected	Inconsistencies in claim documents	Ensure all documents are genuine; never inflate bills

FAQ — EXTENDED QUESTIONS

Q P1. What is Acko's approach to data privacy and can I request deletion of my data?

A Acko operates under the Digital Personal Data Protection Act 2023 (DPDPA) and the Information Technology Act 2000. Your rights: (1) RIGHT TO ACCESS: You can request a copy of all personal data Acko holds about you. (2) RIGHT TO CORRECTION: If any data is incorrect, request correction via Acko app → Account → Edit Details or email privacy@acko.com. (3) RIGHT TO ERASURE (Limited): You can request deletion of your data. However, IRDAI regulations require Acko to retain insurance policy and claims data for a minimum of 10 years for regulatory compliance. Deletion is possible only for data not subject to regulatory retention. (4) HOW TO EXERCISE: Email privacy@acko.com with your policy number and specific request. Acko responds within 30 days. (5) HEALTH DATA: Treated as sensitive personal data under DPDPA. Not shared with any marketing partner. Only shared with: TPA (for claims processing); network hospitals (for cashless); IRDAI (regulatory reports). (6) TELEMATICS DATA (Motor): If you use Acko's app-based telematics for usage-based insurance, driving data is used only for premium calculation — not shared externally.

Q P2. Can NRIs (Non-Resident Indians) buy Acko health insurance?

A Acko health insurance is designed primarily for Indian residents. However: (1) NRIs visiting India: Can purchase a short-term health policy for their stay in India. Standard waiting periods apply, which may limit usefulness for short trips. Travel insurance with medical coverage is more practical for visits up to 90 days. (2) NRIs with regular India visits: If you spend 180+ days in India per year, a standard Acko health policy makes sense. Coverage is valid only when you are in India — no international coverage. (3) NRIs returning to India: If returning permanently, start a personal Acko health policy from Day 1. Waiting periods begin from inception date. (4) Coverage for NRI family members in India: If your parents or family are in India and you are abroad, you can purchase Acko health insurance for them from abroad. They will use the policy in India; you pay the premium from your NRE/NRO account or Indian account. (5) International health coverage: For health coverage when abroad, consider Acko international travel insurance or a global health plan from a multinational insurer.

Q P3. How does Acko handle disputes between the policyholder and network hospital?

A Occasionally, disputes arise between the insured and the network hospital during cashless claims — typically about: non-coverage of certain items; disagreement over room category; unexplained charges added to the bill. Acko's role: (1) INTERMEDIARY: Acko mediates between the insured and network hospital. If the hospital charges items not covered by the policy, Acko clarifies this with the hospital and instructs the insured on what they must pay. (2) NETWORK HOSPITAL AGREEMENT: All Acko network hospitals have signed a service agreement. Overcharging, denial of cashless for eligible claims, or demanding cash payments for covered items is a breach of this agreement. Report such behaviour to Acko immediately. (3) WHAT TO DO: If a network hospital demands cash for items Acko should cover — do not pay; call Acko helpline immediately; document everything with photos; escalate via app. (4) DISCHARGE DISPUTES: If a hospital holds your discharge certificate pending payment of disputed items, this is unethical. Acko's empanelment agreement prohibits this. Escalate to Acko immediately and document.

Q P4. What is the difference between health insurance and critical illness insurance?

A These are fundamentally different products often confused by customers: HEALTH INSURANCE (Acko Health Plans): Covers actual hospitalisation expenses on a reimbursement/cashless basis. Pays the actual medical bills — room, surgery, ICU, medicines. Sum Insured is the maximum but payout = actual admissible expenses. Multiple claims per year possible. Covers many conditions including minor hospitalisation. CRITICAL ILLNESS INSURANCE (CI Plan): Pays a fixed lump sum on diagnosis of a specified critical illness (cancer, heart attack, stroke, kidney failure, major organ transplant, etc.) — regardless of actual medical expenses. Payout is the pre-agreed amount. Single claim per policy. Covers only listed critical illnesses. The lump sum can be used for: treatment not covered by health insurance; loss of income during recovery; EMI payments; caregiving costs. WHO NEEDS WHAT: Health insurance: everyone (covers hospitalisation expenses). Critical illness: high-earning individuals with dependents who would face income loss during a serious illness diagnosis. Having both provides comprehensive protection.

Q P5. How do I ensure my family knows how to use my insurance if I am incapacitated?

A Insurance emergency preparedness for families: (1) SHARE POLICY DETAILS: Share your Acko app login or at minimum your policy numbers, type, and emergency contacts with your spouse/next of kin. (2) ACKO APP ACCESS: Add family members as sub-users on the Acko app where available. Alternatively, share login credentials securely. (3) EMERGENCY CARD: Prepare a physical/digital emergency card containing: your name; Acko policy number; type of insurance; Acko helpline; nearest network hospital; emergency contact. (4) DIGITAL HEALTH CARD: Ensure family members can access your digital health card from the Acko app for cashless hospitalisation. (5) CLAIM PROCESS: Explain to your family: for health — take to network hospital, show health card, hospital contacts Acko; for motor — register claim on Acko app, upload photos, RSA number if breakdown. (6) POWER OF ATTORNEY (for serious incapacity): If you are severely incapacitated, your legal guardian or POA holder can represent you in insurance claims. Acko requires notarized POA document for claims by representatives. (7) NOMINEE: Ensure your insurance nominee is updated and informed about their role in health claims (nominee receives settlement if policyholder passes away).

SECTION K — COMPREHENSIVE CLAIM SCENARIOS

Q K1. My car hit a cow on the highway at night. What claim process applies and what is covered?

A Animal strikes on Indian roads are common — cattle, dogs, and wildlife on national highways are a significant cause of accidents. Coverage and process: (1) YOUR CAR DAMAGE: Fully covered under OD — Accidental External Means (animal collision is treated as accidental damage). Register claim on Acko app. (2) FIR: Not mandatory for animal collision (no third party involved, no person injured). A police complaint/GD is helpful documentation. (3) AI ASSESSMENT: Upload photos — Acko AI assesses bumper, grille, headlights, bonnet for damage. Minor claims approved quickly. (4) ANIMAL WELFARE: The animal's owner (if identified) has no insurance liability under standard motor insurance. (5) NIGHT DRIVING NOTE: Reduced visibility does not affect claim admissibility — accidents caused by poor visibility are still covered. (6) Zero Dep: If active, full part replacement without depreciation. Bumper and grille are plastic parts — 50% depreciation without Zero Dep.

Q K2. My car was vandalized in a parking lot — scratches all over. How do I claim?

A Vandalism by a third party falls under the OD section — Malicious Acts by Third Parties. Here's the full process: (1) FILE POLICE COMPLAINT: A police General Diary (GD) entry or FIR is required as evidence that damage was caused by malicious act, not an accident. This is important — without police documentation, Acko cannot verify the cause of the scratches. (2) REGISTER CLAIM on Acko app. Mention "vandalism" as cause. Upload photos — close-ups of each scratch/dent. (3) SURVEYOR: A physical surveyor may be dispatched for widespread damage. For a single-area scratch, AI assessment may suffice. (4) SETTLEMENT: Full body repaint cost is admissible minus 50% on paint material (standard policy) or full cost (Zero Dep). Metal panel repair is at full cost. (5) NCB IMPACT: Making this claim resets NCB — consider paying out of pocket for minor scratches to preserve NCB.

Q K3. I am involved in an accident involving multiple vehicles — how does the claim work?

A Multi-vehicle accidents involve multiple insurance policies and can be complex. Here is how it unfolds: (1) SAFETY FIRST, PHOTOS SECOND: After ensuring safety, photograph all vehicles involved, all number plates, the road and debris, and skid marks. (2) EXCHANGE INFORMATION: Get all parties' name, vehicle registration, insurance company, and policy number. (3) YOUR OD CLAIM: Covers your own vehicle damage regardless of who is at fault. Register with Acko regardless of fault attribution. (4) TP CLAIM against at-fault driver: If another driver caused the accident, you can claim from their TP insurer directly (or through MACT). This is separate from your OD claim. (5) AT-FAULT LIABILITY: If you caused the accident, your TP covers other parties' damage up to INR 7.5 lakhs per accident (property). Bodily injury is unlimited. (6) SHARED FAULT: In India, contributory negligence is recognized. Both parties' insurers may share liability proportionately. (7) ACKO'S ROLE: Acko handles your OD claim; Acko's legal team handles any MACT proceedings on your TP section.

Q K4. My bike was completely flooded during heavy rain in my building's basement parking. What claim do I get?

A Flood damage to a parked vehicle — whether on the road or in a basement parking lot — is covered under OD (Natural Calamity — Flood/Inundation). Here is the detailed claim picture: (1) OWN VEHICLE DAMAGE: Covered under flood/inundation peril. This includes: engine, electrical system, interiors, all mechanical components affected by water. (2) ENGINE PROTECTION ADD-ON: If water entered the engine and caused hydrostatic lock — Engine Protection add-on is needed for engine-specific coverage. Standard OD covers flood water entering cabin and electrical damage but the engine damage from water ingression is specifically covered only with Engine Protection. (3) NOT REQUIRED: FIR not needed for natural calamity claims. Simply register on Acko app, photograph the flooded bike and surrounding parking area, and document water level marks. (4) SURVEYOR: Dispatched within 24-48 hours. Do not attempt to start the bike before surveyor inspection. (5) TP (Society or Parking Owner): If building management's negligence contributed to basement flooding (inadequate waterproofing, faulty drainage), you may have a civil claim against them — separate from your insurance claim.

Q K5. I was hospitalised in an emergency at a non-network hospital in a remote area. What is the reimbursement process?

A Emergency hospitalisation at non-network hospitals is covered under the reimbursement process. Here is a detailed walkthrough: (1) ADMIT FIRST, INFORM ACKO WITHIN 24 HOURS: In a life-threatening emergency, get the best available treatment immediately. Inform Acko within 24 hours of admission via app. (2) PRE-AUTH FOR NON-NETWORK: While pre-auth is designed for network hospitals, Acko has an emergency process for non-network admissions. Contact Acko helpline and inform them — they may provide a cashless authorization letter even for non-network hospitals if it qualifies as a genuine emergency. (3) COLLECT ALL DOCUMENTS BEFORE DISCHARGE: Original bills, itemised cost breakdown, discharge summary, diagnostic reports, doctor's prescriptions, lab reports. Get the hospital's registration certificate copy. (4) SUBMIT WITHIN 30 DAYS OF DISCHARGE: Upload all documents via Acko app. (5) PROCESSING TIME: 10-20 working days from complete document submission. (6) ASSESSMENT: Acko assesses based on standard rates for the procedure in that geography — some procedures may be valued at standard rates, not actual bills if they significantly exceed norms. (7) REIMBURSEMENT: Admissible amount transferred to bank account via NEFT.

SECTION L — SPECIAL TOPICS AND EDGE CASES

Q L1. Can I insure a vintage/classic car (25+ years old) with Acko?

A Yes — Acko covers classic and vintage vehicles, though the process differs from standard policies. Key aspects: (1) IDV DETERMINATION: For vehicles above 5 years, IDV is agreed by mutual consent between you and Acko. For genuine vintage vehicles (25+ years), a specialist valuation may be required — typically done by ARAI or an approved vintage car valuer. The agreed value reflects the current market price for that specific model, not depreciated original price. (2) PREMIUM: Higher rates may apply due to: limited garage network for specialist repair; imported or custom-fabricated parts; higher theft attractiveness. (3) USAGE: Standard comprehensive cover applies for road use. If the car is used for vintage car rallies or exhibitions only, a declared-use policy with restricted mileage may offer better rates. (4) CLAIM ASSESSMENT: For vintage car claims, specialized surveyors familiar with the model assess damage. Parts that are no longer manufactured may require custom fabrication — costs assessed case by case. (5) COLLECTOR'S VALUE: Acko acknowledges that a perfectly restored 1967 Ambassador or 1958 Premier Padmini has collector's value beyond the mechanical worth — this is factored into the agreed IDV.

Q L2. I drive my private car for Ola/Uber. Is it covered under my personal insurance?

A This is one of the most important questions for gig economy drivers — and the answer is nuanced: (1) STANDARD PRIVATE CAR POLICY DOES NOT COVER COMMERCIAL USE: If you are driving for Ola/Uber, your car is being used for commercial passenger transportation. Standard personal car insurance explicitly excludes commercial use without a commercial permit. (2) WHAT HAPPENS IF YOU CLAIM: If you have an accident while actively on an Ola/Uber ride and Acko investigates, they may discover the commercial use through telematics data, the ride platform's records, or the accident report. This could result in claim repudiation. (3) THE LEGAL POSITION: Ola/Uber mandate drivers to have a commercial permit (All-India Tourist Permit or State Transport Permit) AND commercial vehicle insurance for all registered driver-partners. (4) WHAT TO DO: If you drive for Ola/Uber, get a commercial taxi permit from the RTO and purchase commercial vehicle insurance. This covers both your legal obligation and your insurance requirement. (5) NOTE: Some insurers offer personal car policies with limited taxi endorsement — check if Acko has such an option for select cities.

Q L3. My car was stolen by my family member or employee. Can I claim?

A This is a grey area involving trust, intent, and insurance law: (1) THEFT BY A STRANGER: Clear-cut theft claim — covered under the OD theft section. (2) THEFT BY KNOWN PERSON (Family member or employee): If a family member or employee takes the car without your permission and does not return it, this may be reportable as theft. However: insurance companies are cautious about family theft claims — police and courts treat family vehicle disputes differently from stranger theft. The FIR is essential — without an FIR for theft, Acko cannot process the claim. (3) FRAUD RISK: Staged theft claims (colluding with a known person to claim theft) constitute insurance fraud and can result in criminal prosecution. (4) ACKO'S INVESTIGATION: For theft claims involving known individuals, Acko conducts a thorough investigation before settling. GPS data, usage patterns, and circumstantial evidence are all reviewed. (5) PRACTICALLY: If a family member has taken the car legitimately and has not returned it, this is typically a civil/family dispute rather than an insurance matter. Consult a lawyer.

Q L4. I took my car to Nepal for a vacation. Is my Acko insurance valid there?

A Standard Acko motor insurance covers the Insured Vehicle only within the geographical boundaries of India (including Indian territorial waters). Coverage does NOT automatically extend to Nepal, Bhutan, Sri Lanka, or Bangladesh — even though bilateral agreements between India and these countries allow Indian-registered vehicles to cross the border. (1) FOR NEPAL AND BHUTAN: You can request a special endorsement from Acko for temporary international coverage. This endorsement extends your OD and TP coverage to Nepal/Bhutan for the duration of your trip. Additional premium applies. Apply before your travel date. (2) THIRD PARTY IN NEPAL: Nepalese law requires valid TP insurance for vehicles on Nepalese roads. Indian TP insurance may be accepted with the Acko endorsement — confirm with Acko before travel. (3) WITHOUT ENDORSEMENT: Any accident in Nepal without the international coverage endorsement = no insurance claim. You bear full personal liability. (4) HOW TO GET THE ENDORSEMENT: Contact Acko via app or email at least 7 days before your travel date. Provide trip dates and destination country.

Q L5. My employer provides health insurance — do I still need personal health insurance?

A Yes — strongly recommended. Here is why employer health insurance has significant gaps that a personal policy must fill: (1) COVERAGE ENDS WITH EMPLOYMENT: On your last working day (resignation, termination, or retirement), employer health insurance ceases. Any hospitalisation after that date — even for a condition that developed during employment — is not covered. (2) WAITING PERIOD RESTART RISK: If you buy personal health insurance only after leaving employment, you face fresh waiting periods (36 months for PED). By starting a personal policy early in your career, waiting periods are completed well before you need coverage. (3) INSUFFICIENT SUM INSURED: Employer group insurance typically offers INR 3-5 lakhs. A single cardiac surgery costs INR 3-8 lakhs; cancer treatment can cost INR 10-50 lakhs per year. INR 5 lakh is grossly insufficient for serious illnesses. (4) NO PARENTAL COVERAGE: Most employer plans cover self and spouse only. Parents require separate coverage — typically a senior citizen plan or a personal family floater with parents added. (5) BEST STRATEGY: Personal Acko policy (INR 10-25 lakh) for yourself; Super Top-Up (INR 25-50 lakh with INR 5 lakh deductible) to supplement; senior citizen plan for parents. Total premium: typically INR 15,000-30,000/year for comprehensive family coverage.

SECTION M — INSURANCE PLANNING GUIDE FOR LIFE STAGES

Insurance needs change through life stages. Here is a life-stage planning guide for motor and health insurance:

Stage 1: Young Professional (22–28 Years)

First job, first vehicle, starting financial independence.

Motor Insurance	Buy Comprehensive with Zero Dep for new car/bike. Start NCB accumulation — make no minor claims.
Health Insurance	Buy personal health policy (INR 5-10 lakh) immediately — even if employer covers you. Start waiting period clock.
Add-ons	Zero Dep (motor), RSA (motor). No add-on health immediately if budget constrained.
Priority	Start NCB. Serve PED waiting periods. Build habit of renewing on time.

Stage 2: Married Couple (28–35 Years)

Dual income, possibly first home loan, planning for family.

Motor Insurance	Both vehicles on Comprehensive. NCB building on both — likely at 20-35%. Engine Protection for city drivers.
Health Insurance	Family Floater (INR 10-15 lakh) covering self and spouse. If planning family: add Maternity add-on to Platinum plan now (24-month wait).
Super Top-Up	Add INR 25 lakh Super Top-Up with INR 5 lakh deductible — cost-effective way to get high coverage.
Priority	Maternity planning — add it early. Personal policy independent of employer coverage.

Stage 3: Family with Children (35–45 Years)

Children's schooling, growing responsibilities, career peak.

Motor Insurance	Comprehensive with all major add-ons. NCB at 35-50% by now — protect it with NCB Protection. Consider RTI for primary family car.
Health Insurance	Family Floater (INR 25 lakh Platinum) — children covered from 3 months. Cumulative bonus growing. Parents: separate senior citizen plan.
Priority	Don't let NCB lapse. Parents' health insurance is critical — their treatment costs are highest.
Action	Review sum insured annually — medical inflation means INR 10 lakh today is worth less than when bought 5 years ago.

Stage 4: Empty Nesters (50–60 Years)

Children independent, pre-retirement wealth accumulation.

Motor Insurance	Comprehensive still essential. NCB at 50% — guard it carefully. Smaller car = lower premium.

Health Insurance	Upgrade Sum Insured if not already at INR 25-50 lakh. Pre-existing conditions becoming more likely — glad you served the waiting periods in your 30s.
Super Top-Up	Increase Super Top-Up layer as retirement approaches — less employer coverage in the future.
Priority	Review exclusions — confirm all chronic conditions are disclosed and waiting periods served.

Stage 5: Retirement (60+ Years)

Fixed income, highest health risk, vehicle needs changing.

Motor Insurance	Possibly downsizing vehicle. Premium lower. Still need Comprehensive. RSA most critical add-on — emergencies have higher impact.
Health Insurance	Senior Citizen Plan for those who don't have continuity of coverage. If continuous personal policy since younger age — continue same plan, lifelong renewal guaranteed.
Critical Concern	Don't let health policy lapse in retirement — re-entry after 60 is expensive and waiting periods restart.
Tax Benefit	Section 80D deduction of INR 50,000 for senior citizen parents and INR 25,000 for self — maximize this benefit.

SECTION N — ACKO INSURANCE GLOSSARY — QUICK REFERENCE

A complete glossary of terms used in Indian motor and health insurance:

Term	Definition
AAI	Automobile Association of India — membership provides 5% OD discount
Add-on	Optional supplemental coverage extending base policy scope, e.g., Zero Dep, RSA, Engine Protection
ARAI	Automotive Research Association of India — approves anti-theft devices
AYUSH	Ayurveda, Yoga, Naturopathy, Unani, Siddha, Homeopathy — covered Indian traditional medicine
BAC	Blood Alcohol Content — above 0.03% = DUI exclusion applies
Break-In Policy	Motor policy renewed after expiry date — inspection required
CABG	Coronary Artery Bypass Grafting — common cardiac surgery
CRN	Claim Reference Number — issued on claim registration for tracking
Co-Payment	Policyholder's fixed % share of every health insurance claim
CPA	Compulsory Personal Accident cover for owner-driver — INR 15 lakh
CTL	Constructive Total Loss — salvage + repair cost > IDV
Cumulative Bonus	Annual Sum Insured increase for claim-free health insurance years
Daycare	Medical procedure done in under 24 hours — 541 listed procedures covered by Acko
Deductible	Amount policyholder bears before insurance coverage kicks in
DPDPA	Digital Personal Data Protection Act 2023 — governs data privacy
Endorsement	Written amendment to insurance policy changing its terms
FIR	First Information Report — police document for theft and third-party injury claims
Free Look Period	15-day window to review and cancel new health policy for full refund
Grace Period	30-day window after policy expiry for renewal — no coverage during this period
IGMS	IRDAI Integrated Grievance Management System — portal for policyholder complaints
IDV	Insured Declared Value — current market value of vehicle = Sum Insured for OD
IRDAI	Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India — insurance regulator
MACT	Motor Accidents Claims Tribunal — adjudicates third-party injury/death claims
NCB	No Claim Bonus — OD premium discount for claim-free years: 20% to 50%
NTC	Non-Traceable Certificate — police document 90 days after theft for claim settlement
OD	Own Damage — motor policy section covering physical damage to Insured Vehicle
OPD	Out-Patient Department — day consultations, not covered under standard health insurance
PED	Pre-Existing Disease — condition before policy inception, covered after waiting period
Portability	Right to transfer health policy preserving waiting period credits
Pre-Auth	Pre-Authorisation — Acko's written approval before cashless hospitalisation

RC	Registration Certificate — vehicle ownership document from RTO
Restoration	100% Sum Insured reinstated after exhaustion in health insurance
RSA	Roadside Assistance add-on — 24x7 emergency breakdown help
RTI	Return to Invoice — pays original on-road price on total loss/theft
SAOD	Stand-Alone Own Damage — OD-only policy introduced by IRDAI 2019
Sub-Limit	Maximum payable for specific treatment within overall Sum Insured
Surveyor	IRDAI-licensed loss assessor for major motor claims above INR 75,000
TP	Third Party — mandatory insurance for liability to third parties
TPA	Third Party Administrator — processes health claims on insurer's behalf
UGF	Utmost Good Faith — duty of full disclosure in insurance contracts
Zero Dep	Zero Depreciation — add-on waiving depreciation on replaced parts in motor claims